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- NASHE MUKTA KARNATAKA
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- COASTAL AND MALNAD
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- TOURISM PROJECT ANNOUNCEMENT
- GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY CENTRES
(GTCs)
- LEAP MISSION
- PRAJA SEVE DEPARTMENT
- SEVE ONE
- KARNATAKA AI EXCHANGE
- BHU GUARANTEE
- ONE BENGALURU
& ONE KARNATAKA TRAVEL APP

SHATHAKADA PATHA

- CM RAITHA CHAITANYA
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- RAITHA MITRA
- AGRI-EXPORT MISSION
- COMPREHENSIVE RAINFED
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- KARNATAKA PROTEIN MISSION
- GRAMANUBHAVA
- CM JOBS MISSION
- BHARAT JODO YUVA SANGHA
- UDYOGA NIDHI
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- RESERVATION FOR STUDENTS
FROM GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS
- EDUCATION HUBS IN RURAL AREAS
- CM VIDYARTHI SAHAYA HASTHA
- INVESTMENT ACCELERATION
PACKAGE
- FAST-TRACK APPROVALS
& INVESTMENTS
- AEROSPACE & DEFENCE POLICY
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- TEXTILE POLICY
- BALLARI JEANS PARK
- SHRAMIKA NIVASA
- ADVANCED MANUFACTURING
CLUSTER



Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister



Shri Siddaramaiah
Hon'ble Former Chief Minister



Dr. G. Parameashwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister

D. K. SHIVAKUMAR
CHIEF MINISTER



VIDHANA SOUDHA
BENGALURU - 560001

Namaskara,

It has been a hundred days since I was given the opportunity to serve the people of Karnataka. These hundred days have deepened my appreciation of the enormous responsibility we carry in building a better future for crores of Kannadigas.

Shri Siddaramaiah avaru has given Karnataka a strong foundation of social justice, reminding us that governance must stand with those who need it most, and this is a commitment I share and carry forward. The five guarantees have brought meaningful support and security to families across the state. But governance cannot stop with what has already been delivered. It must respond to what people need next.

In these first hundred days, we have begun that work: **7.5% reservation for government-school students** in professional courses, **free student bus passes**, **Rs.29,679 crores** cleared investments with potential to create around **66,000 jobs**, **10,000 Bharat Jodo Yuva Sanghas** for sports, culture and nation building, India's first government-sponsored **AI university**, **AI education from Class 6** onwards, cloud seeding, **Udyoga Nidhi** to create **1 lakh new jobs** in the 10 most backward districts, filling of **72,000 government posts** initiated, and a dedicated **"Praja Seve" department** for grievance redressal under my direct supervision.

These are important steps, but this is only the beginning. I know your expectations are immense, as they should be. Your expectations are a reminder of your aspirations from the Congress government, and you have every right to demand this of us.

We are a government that listens and learns. When necessary, we have the courage to reconsider a decision or change course. That is the strength of a government that listens.

Our goal is a **Drudha Karnataka**: economically strong, socially empowered, technologically advanced, and deeply rooted in its values.

The road ahead will not be easy. Our farmers, particularly those facing drought, remind us how much more needs to be done. The next 500 days demand greater determination and effort. But I have faith in Karnataka's ability to meet these challenges. Karnataka does not wait for opportunities, **it creates them.**

That is the Karnataka I believe in. That is the **Kannadiga Spirit.**

With that faith, my Cabinet and I make you a simple promise: We will keep showing up. **We will keep working. And for as long as I breathe, serving Karnataka and Kannadigas will remain my Sankalpa.**

Always in your service,

D. K. Shivakumar
Praja Sevaka



100 days – 100 ways – One Vision
Drudha Karnatakada Sankalpa.



"To protect and respect our vibrant culture and tradition,"
is a Fundamental Duty of every citizen.
This is affirmed by our Constitution.

CMofKarnataka

<https://dipr.karnataka.gov.in/>

Karnatakavarthe

karnataka information



TAMIL NADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(A GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU UNDERTAKING)
No.417, Pantheon Road, Chennai - 600 008. Phone : 044-2819 1890,2819 0259
Website : www.tnmisc.tn.gov.in e-mail : gmdrug.tnmisc@tn.gov.in, mngprdrug.tnmisc@tn.gov.in

Online Tenders is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, for the supply of **Drugs for Rare Diseases** from the Licensed Manufacturers having three years Market Standing and holding Good Manufacturing Practice Certificate (as per revised Schedule-‘M’) issued by the Drug Control Authority. Direct Importers holding a valid Import License and experienced in the field for a minimum period of three years and Loan Licensees having valid Loan License are also eligible to participate in this tender.

Sl. No.	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1.	Online Tender for the supply of Drugs for Rare Diseases to TNMISC Limited under rate contract system for one year from the date of acceptance	e-022/M(P)/DRUG-024/TNMISC/2026. Dated: 11.09.2026	11.09.2026 at 4.00 PM to 2.10.2026 upto 4.00 PM	21.09.2026 at 10.00 AM to 12.10.2026 upto 4.00 PM	12.10.2026 at 5.00 PM

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at <https://tntenders.gov.in/>. The tender document can also be downloaded at www.tnmisc.tn.gov.in for reference purpose.

DIPR/2807/Tender/2026

Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, DHENKANAL (R&B) CIRCLE, DHENKANAL
Corrigendum to Bid identification No. C.C.E. DKL (R&B)10/2026-27
Letter No. 1954 /Dtd. 07/09/2026

Due to some modification of the Tender Call Notice No. **C.C.E. DKL (R&B) 10/2026-27**, the bid document for the above tender call notice will be available in the website from **Dt.19.09.2026 to 05.00 PM of 03.10.2026** for online bidding and shall be opened at **11.00 AM on dt. 05.10.2026**.

All other terms and conditions of the above tender call notice will remain unchanged.

C.C.E., Dhenkanal (R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal
34001/774/2627 OIPR-34001/34132/1/26-27/0014



बिहार सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग
पथ प्रमंडल, रोसड़ा, समस्तीपुर
(पत्राचार का पता:— परिषद घर—नवादा, दलसिंहराय, समस्तीपुर पिन—848114)
E-mail: ee-rd—div-rs-bih@gov.in , Mob. No.-9470001309
— अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना सं०-07 —

अधीक्षण अभियंता, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ अंचल, दरभंगा के पत्रांक— 1744 (अनु०) दिनांक— 01.09.2026 द्वारा प्राप्त निदेश के आलोक में पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, रोसड़ा द्वारा अधीक्षण अभियंता, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ अंचल, दरभंगा कार्यालय के समक्ष में उपयोग हेतु निम्न सामग्रियों की आपूर्ति एवं अधिष्ठापन हेतु मुहरबंद लिफाफा में कोटेशन आमंत्रित किया जाता है।

- उद्घरण आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकार :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, पथ प्रमंडल, रोसड़ा।
- उद्घरण प्राप्ति एवं खोलने का स्थान :- (क) अधीक्षण अभियंता, पथ अंचल, दरभंगा। (ख) कार्यपालक अभियंता, पथ प्रमंडल, रोसड़ा।
- उद्घरण प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय— 18.09.2026 को 03:00 PM बजे तक।
- उद्घरण खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 18.09.2026 को 03:30 PM बजे तक।

सामग्रियों की विवरणी:—

क्र.सं०	सामग्रियों की विवरणी
1	Conference Tables made by UP VC Diamond Sheet RD 915- 25 Seater
2	Visitors Chair made by Godrej/Damro/Nilkamal or Equivalent- 25 No.

विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु कार्यावधि में अधोस्तक्षरणी के कार्यालय से संपर्क किया जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पथ प्रमंडल, रोसड़ा (समस्तीपुर)

PR. No. 011490 (RCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

गर्भावस्था की पहली तिमाही में माँ की एच.आई.वी. और सिफिलिस की जाँच जरूर कराये।



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PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME
I, MONIKA Yadav, d/o Sh. Surender Singh, r/o VPO Sarai Bahadur Nagar, Ateli, Mahendergarh, Haryana 123021, have changed my name to Mahi Yadav vide affidavit dated 07.09.2026 before Notary Namaul.

LEGAL NOTICE
NOTICE FOR APPEARANCE COURT-MICRO & SMALL ENTERPRISES FACILITATION COUNCIL, MEERUT ZONE, MEERUT, UP
Office of the Additional Commissioner Industries, Surajkund Road, Meerut, UP
Case Ref. No.: 330/2022
Hano Software Solutions (I) Pvt. Ltd. Unit No. 204, 2nd Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Tower, Plot No. C-1 Sector-16, Noida (UP)
Versus
Oneto11 Pvt. Ltd. & Ors. E-2310 - G. No. 10, Subhash Mohalla, North Ghonda, North West, Delhi-110053
That the above-mentioned claimant M/s Hano Software Solutions (I) Pvt. Ltd. has initiated the case against you before MSEFC, Meerut. The case is listed for arbitration hearing and therefore you are directed to appear before the Ld. MSEFC, Meerut and file your reply failing which the claimant will request the Council to proceed further and decide the case ex-parte.
As per Directions Micro & Small Enterprises Facilitation Council, Meerut Zone, Meerut, UP
Sd/- Adv. Sachin Bajpai For the Claimant

PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Vedant, S/o Late Sh. Anil Kumar Singh, R/o L-802 Jaipuria Sunrise Greens, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh – 201014 shall henceforth be known as Vedant Anil Singh. — Vedant

LEGAL NOTICE
IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI (ORDINARY ORIGINAL CIVIL JURISDICTION)
CS(OS) No. 459/2026
SMT. NUPUR GUPTA ...Plaintiff(s)
Versus
SMT. MANISHA RANA AND ANR ...Defendant(s)
To
Defendant no. 2:- SH. ROSHAN LAL, S/o Sh. Amir Chand R/o B-35, Ramesh Nagar, Delhi 110015, WHEREAS the above named Plaintiff has instituted a Suit for Declaration and Permanent Injunction against the above named defendant and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way, therefore, this notice is given by publication directing you, the above named defendant no. 2 to make appearance before the Court of Ld. Joint Registrar (Judicial) on 06th day of October, 2026 at 11.00 a.m. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day mentioned above, the suit will be heard and determined in your absence. Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, in terms of order dated 12.08.2026,
Assistant Registrar (O) For Registrar General

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

IN MEMORIAM



26-08-1927 - 10-09-2012
Mrs. Sarojini Natarajan
M.A. (English), M.A. (Hindi), M.A. (Sanskrit), SahityaRatna, Praveen, Kovid, Dip. in Gandhian Thought, PG Dipl. in Teaching Eng. PG Dipl. in Translation, Cert. in Bengali, Diploma in French Retired Principal & Professor of English, Former Office - Bearer: Principals' Association, Madurai Kamaraj University; Women's Voluntary Service, Ramnad Dist; Sarvodaya Sangh, Ramnad Dist.
Hindi Pracharak
Carnatic music vocalist & vainika
Beloved and remembered in our hearts, minds, and souls
N. Ashok, Family & Friends

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बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड
(बिहार सरकार का एक प्रतिष्ठान)
वरीय परियोजना अभियंता का कार्यालय
कार्य प्रमंडल आरा
वेबसाईट: <http://www.brpnns.bih.nic.in> ईमेल: spe-ara@brpnns.co.in,
SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)



निविदा संख्या—BRPNNL/ARA/ 796

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड / केन्द्रीय / राज्य सरकार / एम०ई०एस०/सी०पी०डब्ल्यूडी०/ सार्वजनिक क्षेत्र के समुचित श्रेणी में निबंधित संवेदकों से SBD अधारित ई—निविदा प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से दो बीड प्रणाली (तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय) अन्तर्गत निम्नलिखित टोल प्लाजा निर्माण कार्य हेतु मदवार दर (Item Rate) प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित किये जाते है। यदि संवेदक बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड में पूर्व से निबंधित नहीं है, तब एकरारनामा के पूर्व इन्हें निगम में निबंधित कराना अनिवार्य होगा।

क्र० सं०	जिला	कार्य का विवरण	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रु० में)	परिमाणु विपत्र का मूल्य (Online Payment) (रु० में) (अप्रत्यक्षपूर्ण)	अग्रघन की राशि (लाख रु० में)	Bid Processing Fee (Online Payment) (रु० में) (अप्रत्यक्षपूर्ण)	कार्य की अवधि (माह में)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	अरवल	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works near Arwal-Sahar bridge towards Arwal including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	2046.78	10000	30.47	11800	3
2	भोजपुर	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works at Bihta-Nasriganj (Near junction of SH 81 & SH 102) including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	973.46	10000	19.47	11800	3
3	भोजपुर	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works at SH 81 between Chandi and Sakaddi including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	1093.98	10000	20.94	11800	3
4	भोजपुर	Construction of (2+1) x 2 lane Toll Plaza including administration and other allied civil works at SH 102 between starting point of SH 102 & Piro including installation, operation & maintenance of Electronic toll collection system software & hardware as well as maintenance of civil work in the State of Bihar.	938.07	10000	18.76	11800	3

Schedule :-

Sl. No.	Activity	Duration
1.	Download/Upload date of bid documents	From 15.09.2026 (10.00 Hrs.) to 25.09.2026 (upto 15.00 HRS) [www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in]
2.	Pre-bid Meeting	21.09.2026, 15:00 HRS Venue :- Conference Hall, BRPNNL, 7, Sardar Patel Marg, Patna-800015
3.	Last Date/Time for submission/uploading of offer/Bid	25.09.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
4.	Date and time for Opening of Technical Bid	25.09.2026 upto 15:30 Hrs (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
5.	Date, time and place of opening of Financial Bid	To be informed later to technically qualified bidder. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
6.	अनुमानित / प्राक्कलित राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तथा कार्य स्थल के अनुसार निरूपण में परिवर्तन किया जा सकता है।	
7.	किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी अथवा शुद्धि पत्र को वेबसाईट http://brpnns.bihar.gov.in एवं www.eproc2.gov.in पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।	
8.	निविदा की वेब अवधि :- बीड समर्पित की अंतिम तिथि से 180 दिन तक। वेब अवधि समाप्त होने की तिथि में निविदाकारों से निविदा की वेब अवधि बढ़ाये जाने की सहमति ली जा सकती है।	
सम्पर्क पदाधिकारी का नाम :-		
1. वरीय परियोजना अभियंता, मो० नं० – 9471004827		
2. परियोजना अभियंता, मो० नं० – 7782860214		
विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।		

PR. No. 011439 (B&C) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

वरीय परियोजना अभियंता
बि०रा०पु०नि०नि०लि०,
कार्य प्रमंडल, आरा

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Road Construction Department
Office of the Executive Engineer
Road Division No-1, Jehanabad,
Road Construction Department Bihar, Patna
E-mail:- eercdjehanabad@gmail.com
MBD BASED DETAILED SHORT NOTICE INVITING Re-TENDER
(Through e-procurement mode only <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)
NIT No.-RCD/Jehanabad/Re-tender/02/2026-27

1.	Designation and Address of the Advertiser	:	The Executive Engineer, Road Division No-1 Jehanabad, Road Construction Department, Bihar
2.	Date of Issue of Notice Inviting Tender	:	Date: 08/09/2026
3.	Period For Download of Tender Document	:	From 21/09/2026 to 28/09/2026 up-to 15:00 hrs. (From Website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) only
4.	Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting	:	Date: 24/09/2026, at 11:00 hrs.
5.	Last Date & Time for Uploading Tender Document by Bidder	:	28/09/2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. On Website: (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Only.
6.	Date, Time & Place of Opening of Technical Bid (By the office of the Executive Engineer, Road Division No-1, Jehanabad, RCD, Bihar)	:	Date- 28/09/2026 at 15:30 hrs. On Website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7.	Date, Time & Place of opening of Financial Bid	:	To be announced by the Office of the Executive Engineer, Road Division No-1, Jehanabad , RCD, Bihar after approval of Technical Bid by Competent Authority. (on Website https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Serial/ Package No.	District /Road Division	Name of Roads	Length (Kms)	Cost of BOQ (To be paid through online mode) (Non-Refundable) (in INR)	Bid Processing Fee (To be paid through online mode) (Non-Refundable) (in INR)	Estimated Cost Value (ECV) in INR Lakh	Earnest Money/ Bid Security in INR Lakh	Name of the Office where the Original Instrument of EMD, if paid offline in form of BG has to be submitted
Package No.- 46A								
1	Road Division No-1, Jehanabad	Bibipur-Barawan-Mogalbigha Road	-	10000.00	As per eproc 2.0	11346.50	123.50	Office of the Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division No-1, Jehanabad
2		Bairagibag to Vanabar via Pinjora, Nawabganj, Vishunganj Road	28.25					
3		Bandhuganj-Bharthar-Sukiyama-Tirra-Birra Road	9.86					
4		Daharpur to Satampur via Ahiyasa Road	5.00					
5		Hati more-Korra-Mosimasarai Road	18.00					
6		Kajisara-Imlaiya Road	14.55					
7		Bandhuganj-Bharthar-Sukiyama Road	12.54					
8		Bhakhra more-Banshibigha-Paraman Road	9.35					
9		Ghosi-Dhamapur Road	6.76					
10		Saho Bigha to Dhamapur Road	11.20					
11		S.S College Jehanabad to Barbatta more Road	5.70					
12		Chandharriya-Habilpur-Cherui-Dhamapur-Ghosi Road	5.00					
13		Bandhuganj-Okri-masaurhi Road	15.00					
14		Jehanabad-ghosi-Islampur-Giriyak-Parwatipur Road (SH-71)	22.50					
Total Length			171.21					
Package No.-46B								
1	Road Division No-1, Jehanabad	Shakurabad-Kurtha Road	9.660	10000.00	As per eproc 2.0	13272.500	142.80	Office of the Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division No-1, Jehanabad
2		Jehanabad (NH-110) College to Kalpa via Chakia-Larsa Road	4.100					
3		Jehanabad (NH-83)-Kalpa kenari-Dhuriya-Neriya-chiksi (SH-69)-Adamampur Road	22.246					
4		Makhdumpur Barabar Road	9.000					
5		Nauru - Mai Halt Road	1.600					
6		Durga Asthan to Jehanabad Court Road	0.570					
7		Sarthua - Mandli - Karauta - Sakurabad Road	9.800					
8		Makhdumpur-Paibigha Road	5.850					
9		Makhdumpur-Paibigha Road to Rampur	8.850					
10		Shakurabad-Ghenjan Road	12.000					
11		Nehalpur (NH-110) to Shakurabad-Kurtha Road	6.600					
12		Makhdumpur - Sonma - Hulasganj - Khudaganj Road	20.150					
13		Babhna - Shakurabad Road	8.700					
14		Tehta NH-83 Left out Road	2.200					
15		Ghosi - Sukiyama - Hulasganj - Khudaganj Road	16.60					
16		Tehta-Sugoon-Kurtha Road	9.700					
17		NH-83 Makhdumpur Left out Road	3.930					
18		NH-83 Jehanabad Left out Road	7.480					
Total Length			159.036					
8.	Period of Contract: 84 Months							
9.	Date, Time & Place of Opening of Financial Bid : to be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation on Website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in							
10.	Bid Validity:-180 Days							
Executive Engineer Road Division No-1, Jehanabad Road Construction Department, Bihar, Patna								
PR. No. 011425 (RCD) 2026-27								
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar								
गर्भावस्था की पहली तिमाही में माँ की एच.आई.वी. और सिफिलिस की जाँच जरूर कराये।								



AGENDA CONCERNS
'Rahman keen to visit India at the earliest'

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LINGERING POLLUTANTS
Waste burning, emissions rise sharply in winter: study

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RAJATH IN COLOMBO
India, Sri Lanka sign 3 defence sector MoUs

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ECONOMIC PUSH
Powered by many engines
The State's growth cannot depend on one city, says Karnataka CM

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CAUSING A FLUTTER
Shelton stuns Alcaraz in exciting contest

SPORT » PAGE 15

Hormuz tensions flare as Iran, U.S. intensify strikes

U.S. attacks Iranian oil tankers and Tehran responds by targeting at least 20 ships trying to pass through the Strait of Hormuz; Brent crude futures cross \$100 a barrel for first time since July 2024

Stanly Johny

Tensions between the United States and Iran flared again on Tuesday night after U.S. forces struck five Iranian oil tankers in retaliation for what Washington said was Tehran's attack on its warships near the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran responded by firing a barrage of ballistic missiles at the U.S. base in Al-Azraq in Jordan, and targeted at least 20 ships trying to pass through the Strait, according to the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC).

This is the second U.S. strike on Iranian oil tankers in less than a week, which U.S. Central Command (CENTCOM) said was a direct response to Iran's attacks on American



An image released by the U.S. Navy on Wednesday shows a sailor on the flight deck of guided-missile destroyer USS Mason. AFP

warships enforcing a naval blockade on Iranian ports. Following the flare-up, Brent crude futures breached \$100 a barrel on Wednesday, for the first time since July 2024.

On Tuesday night, CENTCOM said in a statement that U.S. forces destroyed five Iranian crude

oil carriers after the IRGC targeted a Navy warship with ballistic missiles twice over the past two days.

"In response to Iran's most recent failed attacks, CENTCOM destroyed the IRGC crude oil carriers M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, and M/T Riesco in the Gulf of Oman

as well as M/T Derya near Kharg Island. American forces directed the crews to abandon ship before the vessels were struck and rendered inoperable," CENTCOM said.

The IRGC said in a statement that its forces continue to exercise full control over the Strait. It also, according to an AFP report, added parts of the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea to a new "prohibited zone", saying that exact coordinates will be announced later. "If a vessel enters that area without coordination, it will be subject to our sanctions," IRGC spokesperson Hossein Mohebi told state television.

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EDITORIAL
» PAGE 6

Pushed to action



On shaky ground: Municipal Corporation of Delhi personnel dismantling an unsafe structure on Wednesday following the fatal multi-storey building collapse at Satya Niketan. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP (REPORT ON PAGE 2)

IN BRIEF

CM orders probe into remarks on Telangana Speaker

HYDERABAD
The Telangana Chief Minister on Wednesday announced an inquiry into incidents that occurred from Sunday, including the alleged abusive remarks made by Bharat Rashtra Samithi MLCs against the Speaker. » Page 4

S-G: Centre may challenge ruling on NSA detention

NEW DELHI
Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta on Wednesday orally indicated the government's intent to challenge an Allahabad HC decision to quash an order to detain a student under the NSA in April this year. » Page 10

Centre against English being 'native' language

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre told the Supreme Court on Wednesday that it "has an issue" with treating English as an indigenous language, but assured the court that it would move quickly with consultations on granting current Class 6 students a one-time reprieve from a mandatory third-language paper in the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Class 10 examination.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, standing in for Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, said a

meeting would be arranged "today or tomorrow" with the officials concerned for a decision on the issue of a reprieve for Class 6 students. When senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan sought an order from the court on the issue of English being shifted to the "non-native" or foreign language category, Mr. Mehta said, "We have an issue about that. We would like to make submissions on that."

Meanwhile, the court issued notice to the government on petitions filed by minority schools regarding the implementation of the three-language scheme.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

SC questions notice to student over NEET stir

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Wednesday questioned the show-cause notice by an Executive Magistrate of the Greater Noida Commissionerate to a student of Gautam Buddha University in connection with the NEET-UG protests at Jantar Mantar, despite a clear Supreme Court order barring coercive action against students.

Meanwhile, a social media post by the Deputy Commissioner of Police, Greater Noida, said the notice had already been withdrawn, and the officials involved were facing disciplinary action.

The statement also said

the District Magistrate, Gautam Buddha Nagar, had no role whatsoever in the issue.

Making an oral mentioning on behalf of the student, Akshat Tripathi, senior advocate Biswajit Bhattacharya said the issuance of the notice was "prima facie contempt" of a September 1 order of the top court.

Justice Joyimalya Bagchi pointed out that the notice had been withdrawn the next day of its issuance. But Mr. Bhattacharya said that the contempt of the top court could not be purged by withdrawing the notice.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

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M.P. govt. hikes MBBS interns’ stipend by 50% amid protests

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The Madhya Pradesh government on Wednesday announced a 50% increase in the monthly stipend of MBBS interns, after three days of protests by hundreds of medical interns in Bhopal and several rounds of discussions between their representatives and authorities.

Two policemen were also attached to police lines in connection with the action against protesters on Monday.

The decision comes amid various doctors’ bodies, including the Madhya Pradesh Junior Doctors’ Association (JUDA), boycotting routine medical services like OPD across the State, and senior doctors and teachers’ groups extending support to the interns. The move brought cheers to the protesters in Bhopal and other parts of the State.

Deputy Chief Minister and Health Minister Rajendra Shukla said on X that the decision was taken after discussions with the re-

presentatives of interns, JUDA, and Medical Teachers’ Association (MTA). At present, the stipend is ₹14,337 per month. “Swift decisions with sensitivity in the interest of the youth. After dialogue with the delegation of interns, JDA, and MTA, a decision was made to increase the stipend by 50%,” he wrote.

Following the decision, the interns called off their sit-in near the CM’s residence in Bhopal.

The interns had earlier faced police action during their protest.

AISA and SFI announce alliance for DUSU poll

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The All India Students’ Association (AISA) and the Students’ Federation of India (SFI) on Wednesday announced an alliance to contest the upcoming Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) election.

In a joint statement, the two Left outfits said the alliance was formed amid sustained SFI-AISA-led protests that, they claimed, led to then Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation.

Political campaign

“It is this renewed political energy that has now entered the Delhi University campus. Students are responding positively to the SFI-AISA campaign that puts their real concerns at the centre and challenges the money and muscle pol-

itics represented by Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) and National Students’ Union of India (NSUI),” they said. The outfits also cited the recent building collapse at Satya Niketan, saying it had exposed unsafe living conditions.

The two outfits contested the DUSU election together last year and are seeking to challenge the ABVP-NSUI dominance. Three of the four members of the current central panel are from the ABVP and one is from the NSUI.

Key issues

The alliance will campaign on affordable and safe student housing, concessional Metro passes, no fee hikes, quality public education, academic freedom and opposition to the “safronisation” of education, the joint statement said.

Timings

DELHI

THURSDAY, SEP. 10			
RISE	06:04	SET	18:32
RISE	04:59	SET	18:02
FRIDAY, SEP. 11			
RISE	06:04	SET	18:31
RISE	06:02	SET	18:33
SATURDAY, SEP. 12			
RISE	06:05	SET	18:30
RISE	07:03	SET	19:04

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	35	25
Safdarjang	35	25
Palam	35	23

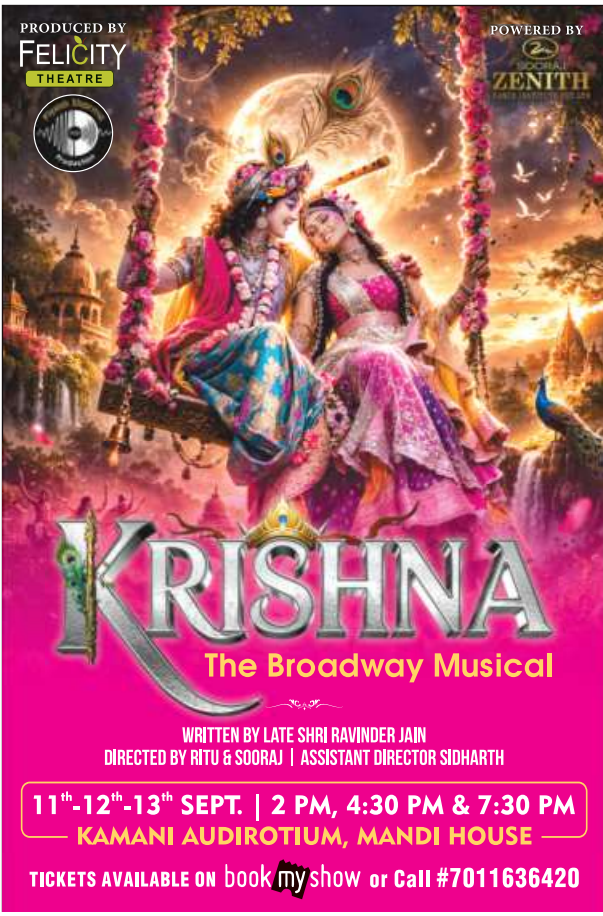
Delhi Palam Today
35°C The weather will be dry. Day will be warm. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C Rise in temperature. The weather will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable. Mostly dry weather to occur.

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INBRIEF



Arvind Kejriwal re-elected
AAP national convener

The Aam Aadmi Party’s (AAP) national council on Wednesday re-elected Arvind Kejriwal as the party’s national convener, the highest post in AAP, the party said in a statement. The party’s 15th national council meeting was held under his chairmanship and a total of 330 members participated. “During the meeting, a new 23-member national executive was constituted. Mr. Kejriwal has once again been unanimously elected as AAP’s national convener. Pankaj Gupta has been elected as the national secretary, while N.D. Gupta will continue as the national treasurer,” the statement said.

Fire erupts in Surat textile
market; many shops damaged

A massive fire erupted at a multi-storey textile market in Gujarat’s Surat city, damaging more than a dozen shops and leaving a firefighter injured, police said on Wednesday. The fire broke out at around midnight in the Shyam Sangini textile market and affected shops located on its sixth floor, they said. As many as 25 firefighting vehicles, turntable ladders, hydraulic platforms and nearly 150 fire personnel and officers were deployed to control the blaze, Chief Fire Officer Basant Pareek said. The blaze was brought under control after 7 to 8 hours, he said. Local traders said the fire destroyed synthetic goods kept outside the shops on the sixth floor. PTI

Clashes mar
first phase of
Rajasthan
urban polls

Press Trust of India
JAIPUR

A tentative 72.09% voter turnout was recorded in the first phase of Rajasthan’s urban local body elections on Wednesday, with incidents of clashes, alleged bogus voting and EVM-related disruptions reported from some places.

In Fatehpur of Sikar district, stone-pelting took place between supporters of a Congress candidate and an independent candidate, in which two people were injured.

In the Jhunjhunu Municipal Council’s Ward 35, CPI(M) candidate Mahipal Poonia alleged bogus voting and claimed that police personnel were supporting those casting fraudulent votes. Earlier in the day, EVM-related disruptions were also reported at several places.

1,169 candidates set
to win unopposed in
Tripura village polls

Syed Sajjad Ali
AGARTALA

A record number of candidates contesting the upcoming village committee elections under the Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council are set to win unopposed owing to the lack of rival nominations.

The State Election Commission (SEC) said on Wednesday that polling will not be held in 1,169 seats, accounting for one-third of the 4,597 seats across 587 village committees, because only solitary nominations have been received. The SEC said scrutiny of all the 10,958 nominations filed was conducted during the day.

Most of the candidates set to win unopposed belong to the Tipra Motha. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), the Tipra Motha, and

the Indigenous People’s Front of Tripura had earlier announced that they would jointly contest the elections. However, the three parties have failed to arrive at a seat-sharing formula so far. A senior Minister said the alliance is nothing but an arrangement to keep the CPI(M) and the Congress at bay.

Contesting same seats

The Tipra Motha and the BJP have even fielded candidates for the same seats in several village committees. September 10 is the last date for withdrawal of nominations.

The SEC assured that the elections would be held in a peaceful manner on September 28. It added that the Ministry of Home Affairs has sanctioned 24 companies of Central forces to be deployed in sensitive areas in the State.



HPCC President Rao Narender Singh (left) and State in-charge Sanjay Dutt at a Samvaad meeting. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The August 21 arrest of eight workers and the subsequent August 25 protest led by Haryana Pradesh Congress Committee President Rao Narender Singh directly stem from an intensive overhaul to rebuild the State Congress’s grassroots organisation – a structure that had remained completely dysfunctional for more than a decade.

The party launched the “Sangathan Srijan Abhiyan” to correct its course after three consecutive Assembly defeats and years of internal factionalism.

Regular dialogue

The organisational overhaul is being accompanied

by an attempt to bring greater accountability into the party with the leadership seeking regular dialogue between senior leaders and grassroots workers, periodic evaluation of office-bearers’ performance, and a formal system of monitoring. The party has simultaneously introduced a performance-based grading system.

“Soon after Sanjay Dutt took over as State in-charge in June, a meeting of all senior leaders from across the State – MPs, MLAs and district presidents – was held. It was followed by interaction with district executive members and active workers in each Assembly to seek their feedback under the ‘Samvad’ programme,” Rao Narender Singh told *The Hindu*.

The outreach has co-

vered 78 of Haryana’s 90 Assembly constituencies, he said.

Issues remain

The effort has begun to change the mood among the rank-and-file, according to party workers. “The mood is upbeat. It is after a gap of several years that the party’s State leadership has turned towards the grassroots workers to interact with them and seek their feedback,” said Raju Maan, national convener of the All India Kisan Congress.

Former Hissar MP Brijendra Singh said the Congress organisation was finally taking shape after 12 years, with party activities now more visible across the State and districts, and the Youth Congress and NSUI being activated.

Mr. Maan cautioned that

appointments are based on recommendations of senior leaders rather than merit. For instance, Charkhi Dadri, where all four block presidents are Jats and are allegedly aligned with different senior leaders.

“The Congress’s central challenge in Haryana was to ensure that it was not seen as a party representing a particular caste,” said Lal Bahadur Khosla, chairman of the Haryana Congress Legal Department and a Pradesh Congress Committee delegate.

The imbalance in women’s representation is another concern. Of the 33 district presidents, only one is a woman – a gap that assumes significance as women have emerged as an increasingly important electoral constituency being courted by all parties.

Revanth orders probe into
remarks against Speaker,
‘purification’ controversy

Telangana CM makes the announcement in the Assembly during a discussion on BRS workers cleaning with turmeric water the roads taken by Cong. Dalit workers to reach KCR’s farmhouse

R. Ravikanth Reddy
P. Laxma Reddy
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Wednesday announced an inquiry into incidents that occurred from Sunday, including the alleged conspiracy behind the alleged abusive remarks made by Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) MLAs against Legislative Assembly Speaker Gaddam Prasad Kumar.

Hyderabad City Joint Commissioner of Police Vijay Kumar will head the probe, which will cover the sequence of events leading to the alleged remarks against the Speaker and examine whether there was any larger conspiracy behind the incidents.

The Chief Minister made the announcement in the Assembly during a discussion on BRS workers carrying out “purification” with turmeric water of roads used by Congress Dalit activists to reach the farmhouse of BRS president



Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy speaking in the State Assembly on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

and Leader of the Opposition K. Chandrashekhhar Rao (KCR) in Erravelli.

“The government will investigate not only those who allegedly made the offensive remarks but also those who planned and participated in the alleged conspiracy,” the CM said.

He added that a comprehensive investigation will be conducted, criminal cases will be registered, and those responsible will be punished.

The House condemned the incident, stating that it was a crime and an attack on the self-respect of Dalits

and the Telangana society.

The Chief Minister alleged that the BRS had conspired at a farmhouse to provoke its legislators to disrupt the Assembly proceedings as it feared that discussions would expose the corruption, irregularities, and debts during the previous BRS regime.

‘Derogatory comments’

“Those who attack Parliament... terrorists responsible for the Pulwama attack and those who insult the Speaker with casteist mindset cannot be treated very differently,” Mr. Red-

dy said, in reference to the alleged derogatory comments by BRS MLAs.

He alleged that some BRS members not only attacked officials but also insulted the dignity of the Speaker’s chair and made remarks against Mr. Prasad and his mother.

Tension had prevailed for several hours on Tuesday near the farmhouse of KCR at Erravelli in Siddipet district as Congress workers and members of Dalit organisations attempted to march towards the premises as part of a ‘Chavu Dappu (funeral drum-beating)’ protest against alleged derogatory remarks made against Dalits by leaders of the Opposition party.

Scuffles broke out between BRS workers and protesters at some checkpoints. The police also stopped hundreds of protesters who later staged a demonstration several hundred metres from the farmhouse, beating drums and raising slogans. A few police personnel reportedly suffered minor injuries.

Will uproot forces
raising ‘anti-national’
slogans: Bengal CM

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Wednesday renewed his pledge to “uproot” forces raising slogans such as “Kashmir demands freedom” on the Jadavpur University (JU) campus and said he would not tolerate any insult to the saffron colour.

Mr. Adhikari was addressing a gathering outside the campus after leading the ‘Gerua Samman Yatra’. The march, from Golpark to Jadavpur, was attended by hundreds of saints and seers dressed in saffron. Thousands of people and several MLAs also took part in the march.

“I have taken a vow that in Jadavpur, those who raise slogans like ‘Kashmir *mange azaadi*’ and ‘red salute to Kishenji (slain Maoist leader)’ and write ‘*gerua gundami* (saffron hooliganism)’, I will rip you out from your roots,” Mr. Adhikari said.

The Chief Minister had recently called for an inquiry into alleged “anti-national” graffiti and posters that surfaced on the JU campus following alleged clashes between students belonging to the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad and Left-leaning groups



Suwendu Adhikari taking part in the ‘Gerua Samman Yatra’ in Kolkata on Wednesday. PTI

such as the Students’ Federation of India.

Addressing the gathering, he said he would come back to Jadavpur twice – once to teach a lesson to the people who are insulting saffron and the nation, and then to recite the Gita and the Hanuman Chalisa.

Mr. Adhikari warned that people should “think five times” before making or writing offensive remarks about the saffron colour. He said any such insult would not be tolerated by the BJP government.

New appointments

Meanwhile, JU removed Acting Registrar Selim Baksh Mondal and appointed Debjit Dutta as the interim Registrar. Indrajit Bandyopadhyay was appointed as the Acting Finance Officer in place of Shiladitya Chattopadhyay.

Oppn. expresses concern over razing of
Saharanpur mosque, Moradabad notice

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW



A century-old mosque located inside the Saharanpur Collectorate complex was demolished on September 5. FILE PHOTO

Opposition parties in Uttar Pradesh on Wednesday expressed concern that targeting of mosques and structures linked to the Muslim community will intensify across the State in view of the upcoming Assembly election in a bid to polarise people.

The concern comes against the backdrop of the demolition of a century-old mosque inside the Saharanpur Collectorate complex on September 5 and authorities in Moradabad issuing notice recently to the management of the Mustafa Mosque, describing it as an “unauthorised construction”.

The Moradabad Development Authority notice dated August 21, which came into focus on Tuesday, stated that the mosque’s construction map had not been approved.

“With the Uttar Pradesh

regulatory framework, but those linked with the Muslim community are being singled out,” Congress national secretary Shahna-waz Alam said.

‘One-point programme’

Zia ur Rehman Barq, SP lawmaker from Sambhal, accused the Uttar Pradesh government of pursuing a “one-point programme” focused on mosques, madrasas and graveyards, and criticised officials over the demolition of the mosque in Saharanpur. He alleged that instead of focusing on inflation, jobs, education, health care or services for the poor, the BJP government was “harassing Muslims” in the belief that it would help it win polls.

Mr. Barq said the Saharanpur mosque was 119 years old and had documents relating to it. He also criticised notices being issued in Sambhal and Moradabad, calling such action “completely wrong”.

Ruling alliance
led by TVK gets
formal title in
Tamil Nadu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The post-poll alliance led by the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) in Tamil Nadu, comprising the Congress, the Indian Union Muslim League (IUM), the Viduthalaai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK), and the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK), has been named the Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance (SSJVA).

At the second meeting of the alliance partners at the TVK headquarters in Panaiyur on the outskirts of Chennai on Wednesday, the alliance was formally given the name.

TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has been named the chairperson of the alliance. It has been decided that the alliance partners will work together both in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.

Year-long overhaul boosts Haryana Congress, but challenges persist

Ashok Kumar
GURUGRAM

When Indian Youth Congress and National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) workers blocked Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini’s convoy over Gurugram University’s infrastructure last month, the friction signalled a newly coordinated grassroots mobilisation reflecting the results of the party’s year-long “Sangathan Srijan Abhiyan” campaign.

However, this newfound ground momentum remains shadowed by questions being raised on appointments made on recommendations and not entirely on merit, caste equations not being taken care of, and deficit in female representation at district level.



HPCC President Rao Narender Singh (left) and State in-charge Sanjay Dutt at a Samvaad meeting. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The August 21 arrest of eight workers and the subsequent August 25 protest led by Haryana Pradesh Congress Committee President Rao Narender Singh directly stem from an intensive overhaul to rebuild the State Congress’s grassroots organisation – a structure that had remained completely dysfunctional for more than a decade.

The party launched the “Sangathan Srijan Abhiyan” to correct its course after three consecutive Assembly defeats and years of internal factionalism.

Regular dialogue

The organisational overhaul is being accompanied

ED searches premises linked to Jarkiholi and his MP daughter

Agency examining Karnataka PWD Minister’s overseas investment, business ventures; searches unrelated to alleged graft in Excise Dept.

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI/BENGALURU

The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) on Wednesday began conducting searches at the residences and other premises linked to Karnataka Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Satish Jarkiholi and his daughter Priyanka Jarkiholi, who is a Congress MP from the Chikkodi Lok Sabha constituency.

The ED clarified that the latest searches against the Jarkiholis are not related to its searches in June over alleged corruption in the Excise Department, but is an independent new case against the PWD Minister. There is no clarity as to whether the searches are being carried out under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 or the Fo-



Under the scanner: Searches are being carried out at 18 locations, including Bengaluru, Belagavi and Gokak. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

reign Exchange Management Act, 1999, the two laws under which the ED can probe.

The Minister’s alleged overseas investment, and his business ventures are being examined, an officer said. When last checked before going to print on Wednesday night, the searches were still on. ED sources said they have registered a case against Mr. Jarkiholi.

The searches are being carried out at their resi-

dences in Bengaluru, Belagavi, and Gokak, apart from other places. Eighteen locations, including houses of family members, associates, and businesses linked to the Jarkiholi family, are also being searched.

In June this year, the agency claimed that an “organised syndicate involving public officials, intermediaries and private individuals are engaged in systematic collection and distribution of bribes”.

Ahead of extradition, idol theft accused to be handed to Centre

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

International antiquities dealer Subash Chandra Kapoor, who is in a Tiruchi jail in Tamil Nadu for idol theft, is likely to be handed over to the Union government authorities soon, following an order of the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court to repatriate him to Germany, sources said.



Subash Chandra Kapoor

Kapoor, who has been accused of involvement in a number of idol theft cases in the State as well as in other countries, is a U.S. citizen. He was extradited from Germany to India in 2012 in connection with a case registered by the Udayarpalayam police in 2008 over the theft of 19 idols from a temple. As part of the extradition process, India had assured Germany that Kapoor would not be prosecuted in any case other than the one for which he was extradited, without Germany’s consent.

Germany and the U.S. had also sought his extradition in connection with cases pending against him in those countries.

In December last year, Kapoor filed a *habeas corpus* petition before the Madurai Bench, contending that his continued detention in other cases without Germany’s consent violated the Extradition Treaty between India and Germany.

Meanwhile, the Union government sought to take custody of Kapoor and produce him before the Extradition Court in Patiala House, New Delhi. The High Court held that his continued detention was without authority of law and could not be sustained in the absence of the consent of the requested State, as required under the Extradition Act, 1962, and the Extradition Treaty. The court directed the Union government to take custody of Kapoor from the Central Prison, Tiruchi, within two weeks and proceed in accordance with law to return him to Germany.

Kapoor’s advocate A. Manoj Kumar said his client would now be repatriated to Germany.

ED move in CMRL case ‘shameful’, says Vijayan

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM/ KOTTAYAM

Leader of the Opposition in Keralam Pinarayi Vijayan on Wednesday struck a defiant tone as the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government “actively reviews” the Enforcement Directorate’s (ED) demand to incriminate him, his daughter T. Veena and son-in-law and former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas, in what has come to be known as the CMRL-Exalogic “pay-off” case.

Speaking at the inauguration of the Communist Party of India (Marxist)’s (CPI (M)) local committee office at Mannar in Alappuzha, Mr. Vijayan termed the ED’s request to the State Police Chief (SPC) to register a case against him and his family under the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA) as a “shameful” subversion of the criminal justice system for political ends.

“...the ED is attempting a new tack to achieve the political aim of its controllers and those who play second fiddle to its masters by sending a brazenly false set of accusations, masked as a report, to the State’s law enforcement to implicate me in a corruption case,” he said.

The former Chief Minister also sought to defend his daughter, who is at the centre of the controversy. The ED had accused Ms. Veena’s now-defunct firm, Exalogic Solutions, a software consultancy, of receiving sizeable amounts of money from CMRL.

‘Cargo that fell into sea near Keralam could cause future shoreline impact’

G. Krishnakumar
KOCHI

A pollution risk assessment by the International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF) on the containers that fell into the sea after the fire aboard the Singapore-flagged vessel *Wan Hai 503* off the Keralam coast on June 9, 2025, has stated that some shoreline impacts may be experienced in the future “due

to corrosion of the container or loss of the integrity of the packaging (likely to be in decades)”.

“At this time, ITOPF considers that these cargoes do not pose a significant risk to the marine environment,” said the container risk assessment report submitted by the vessel’s registered owner before the National Green Tribunal (NGT).

The Southern Bench,

which took *suo motu* cognisance of the report, *Container vessel on fire off Kerala coast*, published in *The Hindu*, had asked the owners to submit a report with details of the cargo and its environmental impact.

The vessel was carrying approximately 1,754 containers at the time of the incident. It was subsequently towed to the port of Jebel Ali in the UAE in August 24, 2025.

Punjab govt. staff call off strike after assurance

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Punjab government employees, primarily ministerial staff, withdrew their ‘pen-down strike’ on Wednesday following an assurance from the Chief Secretary that disciplinary show-cause notices against them would be revoked.

The employees, who had on Tuesday observed a day-long strike, were demanding that the Punjab government withdraw its letter branding their August 27 mass casual leave taken in protest as “unauthorised

leave”.

The employees were on strike on the call given by Sanjha Mulazam Manch Punjab, an organisation representing employees of Directorates in Chandigarh and Mohali, as well as all government offices across Punjab. They had declared that if their demand was not accepted, they will continue the pen-down strike till September 11. The State government had even decided to implement ‘no work, no pay’ in a bid to clamp down on the protest.

On Wednesday, a meeting was held between re-

presentatives of the Sanjha Mulazam Manch Punjab and Chief Secretary K.A.P. Sinha here. “We were assured that the show-cause notices will be withdrawn, and ‘no work, no pay’ would also not be implemented,” the employees’ organisation leader Sushil Kumar Fauji told *The Hindu*.

Various demands

The stand-off between employees and the government started on August 27, when over three lakh government employees launched a Statewide strike

over their demands, which includes restoring the Old Pension Scheme, release of pending 18% dearness allowance and regularisation of contractual employees, among others. A meeting between the Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and employees’ organisation representatives was called off after Mr. Mann insisted talks could only happen once the strike was withdrawn. “We have also been assured that a meeting with the Chief Minister will be fixed surrounding our other demands soon,” said Mr. Kumar.

20 BRS MLAs suspended for rest of session in Telangana

M. Rajeev
HYDERABAD

Over 20 members of the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) were suspended from the Telangana Assembly for the rest of the Monsoon Session. Speaker G. Prasad Kumar announced the decision on Wednesday. The BRS MLAs were agitated over claims by some Congress legislators that they wanted the BRS chief dead.

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September 11, 2026 | 10:00 AM Onwards | Chennai

Chief Guest**Dr Suchitra Ella**
Co-Founder & Managing Director, Bharat Biotech, CII-President Designate

Presided by**Dr G Viswanathan**
Founder & Chancellor, Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT)

Event Schedule

**Inauguration**
10:00 AM Onwards

**Welcome Address**
10:10 AM to 10:15 AM
Suresh Namboth, Editor, The Hindu

**Special Address**
10:15 AM to 10:20 AM
Dr G V Selvam, Vice-President, VIT

**Presidential Address**
10:20 AM to 10:30 AM
Dr G Viswanathan, Founder & Chancellor, Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT)

**Inaugural Address**
10:30 AM to 10:50 AM
Dr Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder & Managing Director, Bharat Biotech, CII-President Designate

**Gene Editing and Precision Medicine**
2:00 PM to 2:45 PM
Dr Vinod Scaria, Chief Data Officer, Karkinos Healthcare
Dr Kalpana Gowrishankar, Clinical Geneticist and Counselor, Apollo Hospitals
Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences and Technology, VIT Chennai
in conversation with **Geetha Srimathi S**, Senior Reporter, The Hindu

**India as the Global Biopharma Hub**
2:50 PM to 3:35 PM
Dr Maneesh Paul, CEO, Microvioma, Lead Co-Inventor & Program Director of the Anti-Infective Enmetazobactam, Orchid Pharma
Dr Vasan Sambandamurthy, Senior Vice-President, Bugworks Research India Pvt Ltd
Dr M M Balamurali, Professor, Centre for Healthcare Advancement, Innovation & Research, VIT Chennai
in conversation with **Athira Elssa Johnson**, Senior Reporter, The Hindu

**Funding Landscape for Biotech Research in India**
3:40 PM to 4:15 PM
Ajay Mahipal, Co-Founder and General Partner, HealthKois
in conversation with **Serena Josephine M**, Special Correspondent, The Hindu

**Biotech Research and Innovation Ecosystem in India**
4:20 PM to 4:55 PM
Prof K VijayRaghavan, National Centre for Biological Sciences, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research
in conversation with **Jacob Koshy**, Science Editor, The Hindu

**Vote of Thanks**
5:00 PM to 5:05 PM
Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences and Technology, VIT Chennai

**Role of Technology in Biotechnology**
11:50 AM to 12:35 PM
Dr Ganapathy, Honorary Distinguished Professor, IIM Jammu, Distinguished Professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, Emeritus Professor, National Academy of Medical Sciences
Mayur Abhaya, Managing Director, LifeCell International
Dr Shridevi S, Deputy Director, Centre for NeuroInformatics, VIT Chennai
in conversation with **Zubeda Hamid**, Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu

**VIT Chennai Ecosystem for Translational Research**
12:40 PM to 12:45 PM
Dr T Thyagarajan, Pro-Vice Chancellor, VIT Chennai



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Dangerous phase

The Iran war is plunging the region into an economic and security abyss

The crisis in West Asia is escalating on two fronts. On Tuesday, the U.S. said that its forces had struck five Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf waters after what it claimed were Tehran's attacks on U.S. warships in the region. Iran retaliated with a massive ballistic missile attack on the Muwaffaq Salti U.S. air base in Jordan and vowed to respond with greater force to every U.S. attack from now on. It has also announced a new restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz, warning commercial ships against crossing it under American naval escort. Separately, Yemen's Houthis, who are closely aligned with Tehran, launched an attack on Saudi Arabia, wounding dozens. Riyadh has vowed a response. The Houthis, who control northern Yemen and parts of its Red Sea coast, have already enforced a naval blockade of Saudi Arabia's western ports and launched an offensive against the forces of Yemen's Saudi-backed government in Taiz and Mocha. With both the Strait of Hormuz, which connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman, and the Red Sea, a critical trade channel between Europe and Asia, remaining flashpoints, a horizontally escalating conflict from Tehran to Jordan and Riyadh to Bab-el Mandeb threatens to plunge the entire region into an economic and security abyss.

The current phase of the conflict could prove to be deadlier for several reasons. The U.S., which in the recent past has used intense military strikes and economic strangulation as separate policy tools in an attempt to force Iran to surrender, is now using both simultaneously to exert maximum pressure on Tehran. The U.S. naval blockade has largely prevented Iran from exporting its oil, while the American naval escort to a limited number of ships out of the Strait of Hormuz has helped Washington blunt the impact of Iran's chokehold on the waterway on global energy prices. But President Donald Trump was wrong if he thought his maximum economic and military pressure would force Iran to make concessions. Iran, instead, decided to escalate the conflict by attacking American warships outside the Persian Gulf, fully aware that this would invite a stronger U.S. military response. Iran appears to believe that it has a window of opportunity with the U.S. heading into its midterm elections within weeks and Mr. Trump remaining politically weak at home. If Iran's strikes on U.S. military vessels signal a clear decision at the top to escalate the conflict, its missile attack on U.S. bases in Jordan suggests that Tehran has been rebuilding its strike capabilities – capabilities that Mr. Trump had claimed were destroyed. As neither Washington nor Iran seems ready to step back from the precipice, the war is set to enter a more dangerous phase with global economic implications.

Ray of hope

Courts are coming down on reflexive arrests of activists

The district administration in Noida, Uttar Pradesh, went to great lengths to detain 25-year-old Delhi University law student and activist Akriti Chaudhary on April 11, 2026, in connection with protests by workers in the city. But on September 2, the Allahabad High Court quashed her National Security Act (NSA) detention, terming it an “abuse of the draconian preventive detention law” and came down heavily on the administration. The High Court's intervention is a silver lining in the dark cloud of extreme executive arbitrariness that is smothering the democratic soul of India. It termed the Noida administration's conduct “despotic”, its allegations against the activist a “concocted story”, and noted that the District Magistrate had passed the NSA detention order “without application of mind”. Without mincing words, the High Court warned that an unhinged bureaucracy could reduce the State of Uttar Pradesh to an “Orwellian dystopia”. The Division Bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev ordered compensation of ₹5 lakh for Ms. Chaudhary, which is to be deducted from the salaries of the officers concerned. The facts of the case were brazenly in contradiction with the claims of the police and the district administration, but it also took a rigorous and conscientious Bench to provide this relief. It noted in its order that Ms. Chaudhary was already in the custody of the police when the violence that she is accused of took place.

The relief from the High Court has not set the activist free, as she is named by the U.P. Police in 11 other cases. It will be a long journey of legal battles to get her the freedom that every citizen in a democratic country deserves. That the police would go to such an extent to make life difficult for someone who stood up for the underprivileged must shock the conscience of the nation. Between April 10 and 18, 2026, industrial and contractual workers in Noida had staged protests demanding a wage hike and wage parity with neighbouring Haryana. On April 13, the protests allegedly turned violent. The Noida Police claimed to have “strong electronic and video-graphic evidence” of incitement against Ms. Chaudhary, and it turned out to be merely that, a claim which could not be established. Ms. Chaudhary could receive legal support and media attention that hundreds of others in comparable situations cannot easily access, while the workers remain trapped in miserable conditions because of oppressive business models and state policies that favour capital owners, with the promises made to them still unfulfilled. Yet, the Allahabad High Court's intervention in Ms. Chaudhary's case is a ray of hope that democratic protests will be heeded rather than suppressed by the strong-arm tactics of the executive.

A State's development story cannot be the story of its capital alone. Bengaluru is indeed India's pride and the city that has placed Karnataka on the global map. From Information Technology (IT), startups, aerospace and biotechnology to global corporations and new-generation entrepreneurs, Bengaluru has everything that makes it the pillar of India's economy.

But when opportunities are concentrated in one city, so is the pressure. With a population of around 12.5 million and over 11.5 million vehicles, Bengaluru is already facing enormous pressure on its roads, housing and infrastructure. We need to change the pattern of people from rural areas and other cities migrating to Bengaluru in search of opportunities. This is why cities such as Delhi and Mumbai have developed alternative growth centres such as Gurugram and Noida, and Navi Mumbai and Thane, respectively.

The next steps being taken

Karnataka's next chapter cannot depend on one city. It must create several cities and regions that can become strong economic centres in their own right. Taking investments beyond Bengaluru is not an alternative to strengthening Bengaluru; it is, alongside it, an economic strategy for balanced regional development, local employment, new investments, technology and better opportunities across Karnataka. Through Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM), key clusters including Mysuru, Mangaluru, Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, Tumakuru, Kalaburagi and Shivamogga are being developed to take Karnataka's digital and knowledge economy beyond Bengaluru.

If a young person can find a technology job in Mysuru, there is less need for him/her to move to Bengaluru. If a Global Capability Centre comes up in Mangaluru, employment can remain within coastal Karnataka. If advanced manufacturing grows across Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, young people from North Karnataka can find opportunities closer home.

The process is already visible. In June 2026, 55 industrial projects worth ₹7,506 crore were



D.K. Shivakumar

The Chief Minister of Karnataka

The State's next chapter cannot depend on one city; it must be powered by many economic engines beyond Bengaluru

approved, with the potential to create more than 28,000 jobs. Of these, 41 are planned outside Bengaluru Urban and Bengaluru Rural districts. In August 2026, another 83 projects worth around ₹6,253 crore were approved, of which 69 are planned outside Bengaluru, with the potential to create more than 30,000 jobs.

These are approved projects and projected employment figures, not completed investments. But they demonstrate that investment is increasingly being directed beyond Bengaluru. The Local Economy Accelerator Programme (LEAP) has been allocated ₹1,000 crore over five years to promote startups, entrepreneurship and emerging technology clusters beyond Bengaluru, with a target of creating five lakh employment opportunities.

Building around each region's strengths

Under the 2026-27 Budget, LEAP Labs are proposed in Hubballi, Kalaburagi, Hoskote and Mysuru, along with a K-Combinator accelerator and stronger industry-academia linkages. Crucially, the aim is not to copy Bengaluru elsewhere. It is to build ecosystems around the distinct strengths of each region.

For instance, coastal Karnataka has strong foundations in ports, maritime connectivity, education, health care, banking, fisheries and tourism, along with a growing knowledge economy. The next step is to connect these strengths with technology and the digital economy. Similarly, Mysuru already has strong foundations in education, tourism and technology. The government has set the goal of developing it as Karnataka's second IT city under the 2026-27 Budget. Mysuru should not be Bengaluru's replacement; it should become another major technology and knowledge-economy engine for Karnataka.

The Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi cluster has strong foundations in engineering, manufacturing, education and entrepreneurship. It is being developed as an emerging cluster for Artificial Intelligence (AI), machine learning, Internet of Things and advanced manufacturing. Available KDEM data indicate more than 400

startups and over 80 funded startups in the cluster, with more than 4,500 jobs added. The next step is to build on this foundation through AI, data science, drones, electric vehicles (EV), Software as a Service (SaaS), agritech and advanced manufacturing. Tumakuru and Doddaballapura have been identified as an industrial node with the potential to attract around ₹7,000 crore in investment and create more than 88,000 jobs.

So, clearly, 'Beyond Bengaluru' does not mean giving every district the same development model. It means identifying each region's strengths and building the right economic ecosystem around them.

The 'Beyond Bengaluru' model

The goal is also not simply to build IT parks or factories. Education, skills, health care, connectivity, housing and employment must grow together. When industries come, local Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) must benefit. When jobs are created, local youth must have the necessary skills. As cities expand, workers need quality housing, while their families need schools and health care. Tourism must create income for local communities.

That is why the 'Live Near Work' approach, with quality housing close to industrial areas, is important. Industry and human development are two parts of the same economic system. Agriculture must also be part of this transformation. Drones, satellite imagery, digital technology and AI can support crop surveys, crop-health assessment, pest and disease monitoring and real-time agricultural intelligence. Value addition, food processing and stronger supply chains can further strengthen rural economies.

This 'Beyond Bengaluru' model is one that spreads Bengaluru's success across Karnataka. Bengaluru should remain the crown of Karnataka. But the brilliance of that crown must be visible in every district. It means taking the success of Bengaluru and creating new centres of success across the State – a Karnataka powered by many economic engines.

Turning economic cooperation into shared prosperity

A t a time when the international landscape is becoming more complex and uncertain, the case for meaningful international cooperation has rarely been stronger. Its value must increasingly be measured by its ability to deliver stability, resilience and shared prosperity.

For the United Arab Emirates (UAE), this is central to how it approaches BRICS. Since becoming a full member in January 2024, its engagement has been guided by a straightforward principle: economic cooperation should create tangible opportunities for countries, businesses and people.

A diversity that creates opportunities

The strength of BRICS lies partly in its diversity. Its members bring different economic structures, resources, capabilities and development experiences – from major producers and consumers to sources of capital, investment destinations, energy exporters and manufacturing centres.

These differences create opportunities for complementarity – connecting markets, capital, capabilities and ideas in ways that can benefit its members, and by extension the Global South.

The UAE's participation in BRICS is part of its broader commitment to multilateralism, constructive dialogue and diversified international partnerships. It seeks to build bridges between economies and regions. It supports an open international system that advances peace, stability, sustainable development and shared prosperity.

For the UAE, BRICS' ultimate value lies in implementation. Dialogue should translate into easier trade, stronger investment flows, more resilient supply chains, better connectivity and greater opportunities for businesses.

India's 2026 BRICS Chairship, centered on resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability, provides a timely framework for this agenda. At a time when trade restrictions, supply-chain disruptions and uncertainty are increasing costs for businesses and consumers, the response should not be to retreat from global economic integration, but to make it more resilient and inclusive.

BRICS stands out when cooperation can produce tangible benefits: through strengthening



Saeed bin Mubarak Al Hajeri

Minister of State at the United Arab Emirates Ministry of Foreign Affairs

The United Arab Emirates promotes open, resilient economic cooperation through its engagement with BRICS

the multilateral trading system, facilitating trade and investment, improving connectivity, supporting resilient global value chains, and promoting sustainable development.

Development finance is also part of this equation. The New Development Bank (NDB) has approved more than \$40 billion in financing since its establishment, supporting infrastructure and sustainable development across its member countries. The UAE's active engagement with the NDB long before joining BRICS reflects its wider commitment to mobilising capital towards productive investment and long-term growth.

The UAE's own economic partnership with India demonstrates what practical connectivity can achieve.

On UAE-India ties, the UAE's advantages

The UAE-India Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has helped create a more enabling environment for trade and investment between two highly complementary economies. In 2025, non-oil bilateral trade grew by 17% to exceed \$76 billion and the UAE and India have set the ambition of increasing bilateral trade to \$200 billion by 2032.

But the strength of the UAE-India relationship extends beyond trade. It is reinforced by investment, innovation, education, tourism and long-standing connections between their businesses, institutions and people.

This experience points to a broader lesson for BRICS: the strongest economic partnerships are built not only through agreements between governments, but through lasting connections across societies – creating the trust, opportunity, and resilience that allow commercial ties to deepen over time.

Economic connectivity is strengthened when businesses, entrepreneurs, investors, and institutions develop greater familiarity with one another. It is reinforced through education, research, tourism, cultural exchange and engagement of younger generations, which help build the trust and networks on which longer-term economic relationships grow.

The opportunity for BRICS is therefore to deepen the quality of connectivity among its members – connecting not only economies but also institutions, ideas and people.

The UAE is particularly well positioned to contribute because connectivity lies at the heart of its own economic model.

Non-oil sectors accounted for almost 79% of GDP in 2025, supported by world-class infrastructure, trusted financial institutions, advanced logistics and energy capabilities, and an open investment environment that enables businesses to scale-upwards and outwards.

The UAE's ports, airports and logistics networks connect markets across Asia, Africa, Europe and beyond. Its financial centres connect international capital with opportunities across the region, while, its universities, research institutions and innovation ecosystem connect talent, knowledge and ideas.

With sovereign wealth assets exceeding \$2.9 trillion, and 38 concluded Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreements, the UAE has built the capacity to connect capital, markets and economies at scale.

For the UAE, connectivity is not simply about moving goods from one market to another. It is about creating the conditions in which capital, knowledge, technology, talent and people can interact and create new opportunities.

The UAE's approach is not to build economic cooperation around division, but around connectivity.

The path under India's leadership

As India leads BRICS through 2026, there is an opportunity to move further toward delivery: building resilience without closing markets, supporting innovation while widening opportunity, and strengthening connections among the businesses, institutions and people of the UAE and India. The UAE also looks ahead with confidence to China's BRICS Chairship in 2027, where it hopes to build on the momentum of India's leadership and carry forward the same energy of openness, connectivity and practical cooperation.

Ultimately, the success of BRICS cooperation will be measured by the opportunities it creates. That is the approach that the UAE brings to BRICS. As India hosts the 2026 Summit (September 12-13), the UAE stands ready to continue the work that translates cooperation into ways that support shared prosperity.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Dhaka and Sheikh Hasina

Bangladesh's demand for Sheikh Hasina's extradition has placed India in a delicate diplomatic position. Dhaka wants Ms. Hasina to return to face charges related to the student uprising, while India must balance its earlier close ties with the deposed leader against its relations with the present Bangladeshi government. The best option is neither immediate extradition nor outright refusal, but a strictly legal and diplomatic approach. India should examine the request under the extradition treaty and

seek assurances of a fair trial, due process and protection from political persecution, while maintaining dialogue with Dhaka. This would protect India's credibility, avoid confrontation and preserve long-term bilateral relations.
R.S. Narula,
Patiala, Punjab

BRICS is a multilateral organisation and it would be beneficial for Bangladesh to participate in the summit at the highest level. However, linking its participation to Sheikh Hasina's extradition may

not be a smart foreign policy approach. As neighbours linked by civilisational ties and practical considerations, such as a shared border and water-sharing arrangements, it would be in the national interests of both India and Bangladesh to set aside sensitive issues such as Ms. Hasina's extradition and move forward with their bilateral and multilateral relations.
Kosaraju Chandramouli,
Hyderabad

Belated search for peace
There is talk of India exploring ways to

contribute to ending the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict. One cannot help but wonder why it has taken so long. The war has caused an enormous loss of life, destruction and suffering. What is particularly distressing for Indians is the reported recruitment of Indian nationals who went to Russia in search of employment but were subsequently drawn into military service and sent to the war front. If Indians were deceived or coerced into fighting a foreign war, should not the Indian government have taken a

much stronger position and demanded accountability? For over a decade, India has repeatedly projected itself as a country capable of speaking to both sides. Yet, when there are signals that India is seeking ideas that could contribute to ending the conflict, the initiative sounds rather belated.
Tharcus S. Fernando,
Chennai

Eiffel Tower 'incident'

The revolutionaries of 1789 articulated their demands around three core principles: liberty, equality and fraternity. Yet, we are witnessing a troubling

departure from these very ideals in the controversy surrounding the recent protest at the Eiffel Tower – and the allegation of asking women staff to make themselves invisible. The incident calls for deeper introspection. Even as societies aspire to progress and global leadership, institutional practices can continue to perpetuate attitudes that overlook systemic gender discrimination.
Rishika Singh,
Dhanbad, Jharkhand

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

India has to act on its ‘sugar’ problem

This week, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), prodded by the Supreme Court, proposed a simple but overdue idea. Packaged foods high in fat, salt, or sugar should carry a bold red warning on the front of the pack, not buried in fine print on the back. Someone picking up instant noodles, a breakfast cereal, or a “health drink” will finally be told, at a glance, that it is not as wholesome as its advertising claims. This is a welcome step. It is also, on its own, nowhere near enough.

The number of children presenting with morbid obesity and diabetes has climbed sharply within just a few years. The World Obesity Atlas 2026 bears this out – 41 million Indian children and adolescents aged 5 to 19 are now overweight or obese. This is not just because children are eating more; it is about what they are being sold. Breakfast cereals, sweetened yoghurts, and “health drinks” are marketed to parents as filling gaps in a child’s diet, emphasising “energy” and vitamins while saying little about the sugar content inside. In 2024, a leading multinational was found adding sugar to infant food sold in India and other lower income countries; sugar was left out of the same product in Europe. When a health drink, popular in Indian homes, turned out to be nothing more than flavoured sugar syrup, it took a social media storm, and not a regulator, to force the company to prescribe a 15% cut in its added sugar.

The problem is worse around schools and colleges, where studies show that the cheapest, most easily



Dr. Praveen George Paul

Assistant Professor, Pediatric Endocrinology and Metabolism, Department of Pediatrics, Christian Medical College, Vellore



Dr. Vandana Jain

Professor, Pediatric Endocrinology Division, Department of Pediatrics, All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS)

When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices

available snacks are also the least healthy. A popular “energy drink” among teenagers, priced at just ₹20, packs close to 17 grams of sugar, caffeine, and artificial colour into a single bottle. Its label says it is not meant for children, yet nothing stops a child from buying it. This is the market pricing unhealthy calories to fit within the range of a child’s pocket money.

Need for enforcement None of this is a secret. What has been missing is enforcement. The FSSAI and the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) have long recommended what schools should not sell, but optional rules get treated as optional, and canteens stock whatever sells cheapest. A red warning label only works if it is actually enforced.

Moreover, the new rule stops at the edge of organised retail. Most of India’s sugar, salt, and trans fat is eaten unbranded, from street stalls, dhabas, and sweet shops that make up the unorganised sector, none of which is required to declare anything. A red label on a biscuit packet does nothing about the jalebi sold loose beside it. Regulation that reaches only packaged food leaves the unregulated half of the plate untouched.

Then there is the conversation India keeps avoiding – a tax on sugar. When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption among both children and adults fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices. A well-designed sugar tax does not just discourage people from buying a product, it pushes the industry to make the

product itself less harmful.

India already taxes sugary drinks heavily; just not usefully. Since September 2025, aerated and sweetened beverages, sugar free versions included, were folded into one 40% GST slab – so a ‘normal’ cola and its zero-sugar counterpart pay the same tax, leaving manufacturers with no reason to cut sugar. The U.K.’s levy worked differently, taxing drinks in tiers by sugar content, so that companies could lower their bill by reformulating the product. India could tax products in the same way so that manufacturers have a reason to cut sugar.

The standard objection – that such a tax would hit the poor the hardest – is not wrong, but it is only half the argument. Unregulated, cheap sugar already extracts a heavy price from the poor, who bear the brunt of the diabetes, hypertension and childhood obesity epidemic that sugar heavy diets drive, with the least means to treat it. Doing nothing is not neutral; it is a slower, costlier tax, paid in ill health rather than rupees at the till. The answer is to design the tax calibrated to sugar content so that it nudges reformulation, with part of the revenue set aside to make healthy food cheaper.

The FSSAI’s proposed red label is a genuine, if belated, first step. What India needs now is the resolve to finish what it has started – mandatory food standards; limits on how unhealthy food is marketed to children; rules that reach the unorganised sector; and an honest debate on taxing sugar in a way that protects families with the least room to absorb either cost, the tax, or the disease.

The many ways to destroy a book

Last month, a group of citizens in Ahmedabad gathered to read books by Pakistani education activist Malala Yousafzai and Holocaust survivor Anne Frank. This was their way of protesting against the Bajrang Dal and Vishwa Hindu Parishad for forcing a private school to drop books by Yousafzai and Frank from its compulsory reading list. Soon, members of the Bajrang Dal arrived at the scene, beat up the group, and tore up the books.

The targeting of books is as old as the book itself. Books have been censored, banned, torn, burnt, and pulverised to suppress opposing views, enforce state ideologies, silence uncomfortable truths, or for being deemed heretical.

Earlier this month, too, the destruction of books was in the news – but for a very different reason. Various reports in international media said that rare-book sellers were surprised to see a sudden increase in sales. However, the books were not being bought by specialised dealers, collectors, or connoisseurs; they were being purchased by buyers with strange names – Red Sparrow Project, Blue Finch Project, and Green Parrot Project – to train Large Language Models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT. These valuable editions ended up in warehouses, where their spines were sliced, their pages scanned, and the books pulped, so that AI companies would not have to deal with the headache of copyright and e-books.

Why are these two different groups targeting books? The Bajrang Dal said it disapproved of Yousafzai’s perceived views on India and Kashmir. Here, there is a



Radhika Santhanam

clear ideological opposition to Yousafzai’s ideas. The organisation carried out the deliberate act of thrashing people and tearing up books to send a clear warning: do not read this book; and if you do, face our wrath.

In the AI case, there is no such ideological opposition. The book is seen by companies as a mere object that contains ideas. And those ideas are not dangerous; on the contrary, they are important because they can be mined for profit. The more the knowledge fed into LLMs, the greater their capacity to respond, and the more dependent we become on them. What makes this even more worrying is that not all such extraction and destruction is seen as damaging to our cultural spaces or as insults to creators. Not too long ago, a U.S. court ruled that Anthropic’s use of copyrighted books to train its AI was not, in itself, copyright infringement. “One replaced the other,” one of the judges wrote. “There is no evidence that the new, digital copy was shown, shared, or sold outside the company.”

This means that within the framework of our current understanding of “fair use”, a company can buy books written by human beings, copy their contents into a machine, and then destroy the books without even having to compensate the writers. Surely, we need to ask ourselves: have we understood the words “fair” and “use” too narrowly?

Why books matter This practice unsurprisingly sparked widespread anger, which brings us to a more fundamental question: what does the physical book mean to us?

When a book is given to a

child, it can become a precious possession, a way to travel into different worlds of imagination. A book given as a gift by a friend can become a warm memory. A book borrowed from a library for research can be carried around as a vessel of knowledge. A book purchased from a rare-books shop can be as precious as silver, containing layers of history. Books, therefore, have always been more than paper and ink and a spine. They are, of course, textual instruments, but they are also cultural objects – repositories of our thoughts, wanderings, dealings, and feelings. If ideas are what makes us human, books, then, are a physical manifestation of those ideas, which we choose to preserve and pass on.

In *Burning the Books*, Richard Ovenden writes about how, when the National and University Library of Bosnia and Herzegovina came under artillery fire from the Serbian military in 1992, librarians formed a human chain to protect books. In Nazi Germany, a group of Jewish intellectuals, known as the ‘Paper Brigade’, risked execution by hiding books inside their clothing. In the Soviet Union, Samizdat involved clandestinely copying and circulating censored texts, while the modern copyleft movement allows creators to choose to reproduce and share their work freely.

Today, in a world where books are seen either as dangerous or as useful raw material – rather than as things to be read – the ways in which we defend books may have to keep evolving.

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Trade between BRICS countries shows marked increase

The rise in intra-BRICS trade strengthens the case for a cross-border payments system

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis
Gandla Sneha

Reducing global dependence on the U.S. dollar is expected to be a key part of the discussions in the 18th BRICS Summit, chaired by India, happening in New Delhi on September 12 and 13, 2026. Finance ministries’ and central bank governors from BRICS countries met in August to discuss the facilitation of cross-border payments and strengthening of national currencies.

The BRICS bloc with its 10 member countries – Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, and the UAE – has grown in strength in its objective of advancing trade and diplomatic relations within the Global South, which makes cross-border payments desirable.

Currently, making payments across countries requires a string of transactions via correspondent banks, which hold accounts with each other. When two countries do not have such correspondent banks, they route their payments through international banks, converting the currency of the sender country to a dominant currency such as dollars, and then converting the dollars to the currency of the receiving country. This process, besides being slow at times, comes with the cost of foreign exchange margins and the fee charged by the intermediaries. Seeing that the BRICS comprises many developing economies, this can be among the many impediments to trade opportunities.

Trade data shows that merchandise exports by BRICS countries made up about one-fourth of all global exports in 2024 (**Chart 1**). The BRICS countries have all drastically increased their exports over the years, with China touching \$500 billion in 2024. Other members such as Brazil, India, Indonesia, Russia, and the UAE also re-

corded large figures between \$80 and \$180 billion. In addition to this, their trade amongst each other has also increased. **Chart 2** shows that as of 2024, all members of BRICS, except China, received more than 30% of imports from other members.

Iran depends on BRICS for more than 65% of its imports, and Ethiopia nearly 45%. Intra-BRICS import dependency could be on the rise due to the heterogeneity of goods available among its members, as noted in a report by the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development.

Concurrently, export dependency within the bloc has also risen. In the last decade, five members (Russia, China, the UAE, Brazil, and Indonesia) have doubled and even quadrupled their exports to members of the bloc. However, China has consistently shown the lowest dependency on intra-BRICS exports due to its diversified export market (**Chart 3**).

Russia saw a rapid increase in its export dependency between 2020 and 2023, in the middle of its invasion of Ukraine, during which countries such as India imported its fuel. The country saw a decline in export dependence in 2024.

It was under Russia’s chairmanship in 2024 that the BRICS argued against the dominance of the U.S. dollar. Russia was hit directly by the dollar monopoly in 2022; due to sanctions from the U.S., Russian banks were cut off from the Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Technologies (SWIFT) which enables institutions to settle amounts. Hence, international transactions proved difficult for the Russia.

While the U.S. is the largest economy in the world, the BRICS bloc does not fall far behind, as China, India, and Russia are in the top 10 in terms of Gross Domestic Product (current prices) (**Table 1**). Whether this collective economic strength can challenge the dominance of the dollar is to be seen in the coming days.

Dollar detour

The data for the charts were sourced from report by the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development titled “Two Decades of Intra-BRICS Trade: Trends, Patterns and Policies” and the International Monetary Fund (IMF)



CHART 1: In 2025, exports from BRICS countries made up about 25% of global merchandise exports. BRICS countries include Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, and the UAE. Values in \$ trillion

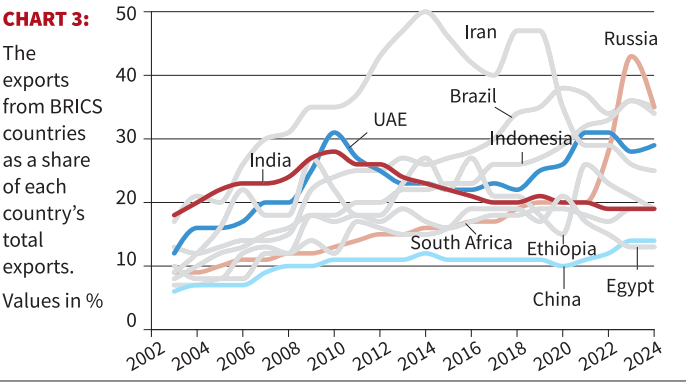
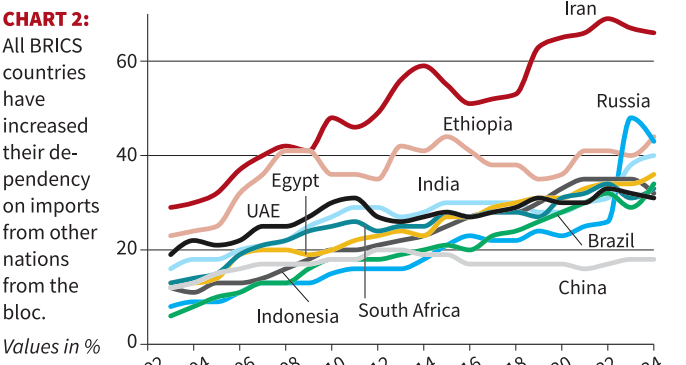
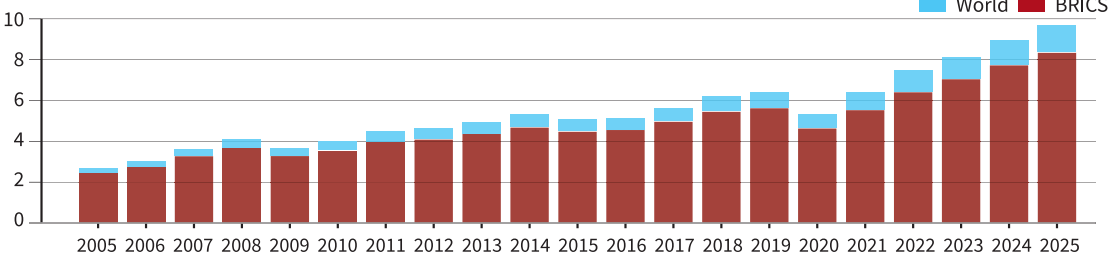


TABLE 1: Country-wise size and ranking of Gross Domestic Product of 2025 (current prices). Values are estimated by IMF

Country	GDP, current prices (billions of \$)	Rank
China	19,626.247	2
India	3,916.312	7
Russian Federation	2,587.938	9
Brazil	2,279.918	12
Indonesia	1,445.642	18
United Arab Emirates	571.643	32
South Africa	427.141	43
Iran	371.196	46
Egypt	364.64	47
Ethiopia	109.109	74

“Collectively, the 10 member countries account for 27 per cent of world output, 24 per cent of merchandise exports, and 22 per cent of FDI inflow by 2024” - Two Decades of Intra-BRICS Trade: Trends, Patterns and Policies report

Gandla Sneha is interning with The Hindu

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu.**

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 10, 1976

Mao Tse-tung dead

Peking, September 9: Mao Tse-tung, the 82-year-old father of Communist China, died to-day at 10 minutes past midnight. Radio Peking broadcast the news to the 750 million Chinese saying: “Mao Tse-tung passed away at 00-10 hours on Sept. 9 because of the worsening of his illness and despite all treatment, although meticulous medical care was given to him in every way after he fell ill.”

Funeral music followed, and immediately thousands of people, wearing black armbands, began to gather in the vast Tien An Men Square (Square of Heavenly Peace) in the heart of Peking. In factories, shops and apartment blocks people gathered around loudspeakers and radio sets. Their faces turned grim and sorrowful at the news of the death of the man who had commanded their reverence and awe. Chairman Mao would have been 83 on December 26. He had been suffering from Parkinson’s disease.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 10, 1926

The Nizam’s protest

The following is from ‘The Daily Herald’ – It is reported from Bombay, says the Indian News Service, that His Exalted Highness, the Nizam of Hyderabad has sent a very strongly worded protest to the Viceroy, urging that in future the relations of the Nizam should be with the Viceroy as representative of the King and not with the Government of India. The Nizam’s contention is that the he had never entered into treaty negotiations with the Indian Government, but only with the British Government.

The Government of India is becoming gradually responsible to the people of India and the Nizam contends, it would be beneath his dignity to owe allegiance to a Government controlled by the people.

The Nizam is strongly supported in this protest by other Indian princes, who look with unconcealed perturbation on the growing encroachment on their “fundamental rights guaranteed by treaties”. The very idea of the Indian people taking to task the old-time rulers is galling to the Maharajahs and Nawabs.

It is a problem which is pressing more and more closely on the Government of India. That Government, however, is anxious, if possible, to postpone the decisive struggle with the old-time rulers – its hands being too full with the problems of the existing situation.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Heatwave days recorded by Spain across June-August

61 Mainland Spain endured its hottest summer since records began in 1961, with an unprecedented 61 heatwave days across June, July and August, the national weather agency AEMET said. The average temperature for those three months was 24.5C, 0.3C above the previous record from 2025 and 2.4C higher than the 1991-2020 reference period, AEMET said. AFP

Death toll in Yemen prison airstrike earlier this week

23 Rescuers dug through the rubble of a Houthi-run prison that was hit in an airstrike in northern Yemen earlier this week, even as the Saudi-led coalition renewed its attacks on Wednesday. Rescuers recovered four bodies, raising the death toll at the prison to 23 people. The flare-up was a major escalation in renewed fighting between a U.S. ally and the Iranian proxy group. AP

Death toll from measles outbreak in Bangladesh

1,002 The death toll from a measles outbreak in Bangladesh has topped 1,000 children since March, health officials said, admitting failures in a vaccination drive. The South Asian nation of 170 million has recorded 1,002 deaths and 187,484 infections among children, according to the Directorate General of Health Services. AFP

Worth of Google's AI expansion proposal in Finland

13 in € billion. Google will invest at least €13 billion in data centres and other digital infrastructure to power its AI ambitions in Finland, in what the U.S. tech giant called its biggest single investment in Europe. The plan also calls for clean energy projects over the next two years, which Google said was “a testament to Finland’s leadership in responsibly building AI infrastructure”. AFP

Amount approved by Chhattisgarh Cabinet for the startup mission

500 in ₹ crore. The Chhattisgarh Cabinet on Wednesday approved a ₹500 crore startup and skills mission aimed at creating new opportunities for employment, skill development, entrepreneurship and innovation for the youth of the State, officials said. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Did OpenAI solve Navier-Stokes problem?

OpenAI's claim of Navier-Stokes breakthrough has sparked controversy after Tristan Buckmaster alleged that its internal model arrived at the exact approach he and Levent Alpöge had been pursuing; questions remain over whether OpenAI trained on private Codex data, the proof's validity and who deserves credit

FULL CONTEXT

Vasudevan Mukunth

The story so far:

In what is quickly becoming an explosive controversy in mathematics, a potential solution to one of the field's greatest open questions has been overshadowed by allegations of espionage and unethical academic conduct. Over the last few days, the mathematical community has been rocked by claims that OpenAI leveraged its enormous computing power – and potentially the private user data of academic researchers – to scoop a solution to the Navier-Stokes equations problem.

What is the Navier-Stokes problem?

The Navier-Stokes equations describe the motion of viscous fluids like water and air, and they have frustrated mathematicians and physicists for more than two centuries.

As OpenAI wrote on its website: “The Navier-Stokes equations use Newton’s second law of motion ($F = m \times a$) to describe how fluids move. Importantly, they treat a fluid as a continuous medium rather than tracking individual molecules. These equations are used for aircraft design, weather forecasting, and the study of blood flow.”

The Clay Mathematics Institute in New York lists a problem about the equations as one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems. That is, anyone who can prove whether the equations always have smooth, predictable solutions or whether the equations can ‘blow up’ – meaning the mathematical solutions reach infinity in finite time – will win \$1 million and considerable prestige in the mathematics community.

What is a forcing function?

The Millennium Prize problem statement, authored by U.S. mathematician Charles Fefferman, offers a few avenues for a valid proof. Options A and B deal with unforced equations, while Options C and D allow for a solution that includes an external forcing function.

A forcing function is an external influence that adds momentum to the fluid, e.g., you dip your spoon into a bowl of water and stir it. A forced blow-up would be when you keep stirring the fluid harder and harder until the equations predict the flow becomes infinitely violent in a finite amount of time – as if you were stirring at nearly the speed of light.

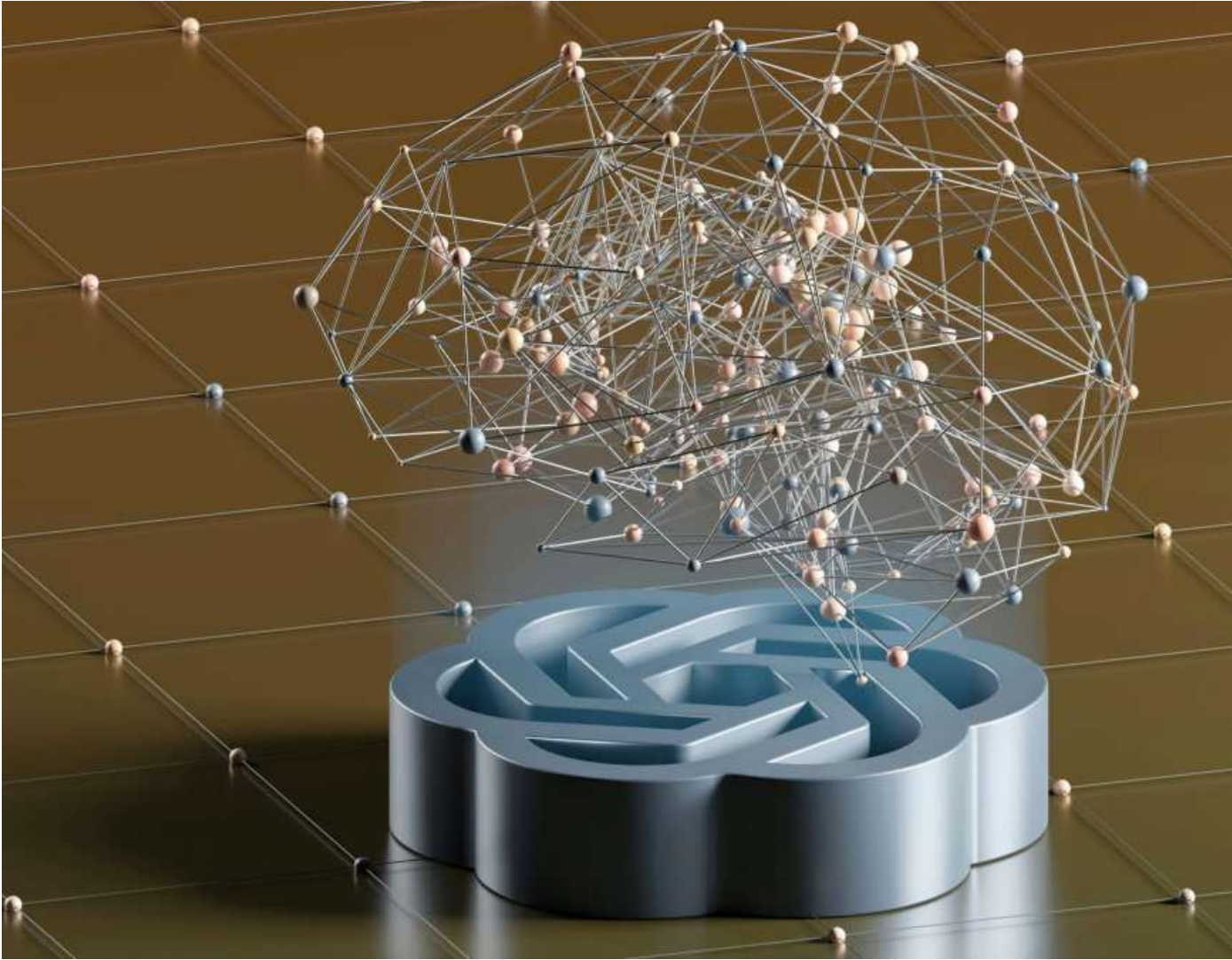
For such a blow-up to qualify for the Millennium Prize under Options C and D, the force causing the blow-up can’t suddenly appear/disappear or change abruptly from one place or time to another. It must obey the usual laws of physics.

Over the last year, New York University mathematician Tristan Buckmaster and Anthropic researcher Levent Alpöge have been using AI models to use a technique developed by Spanish mathematicians Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zoróa to show that forced blow-ups cause the Navier-Stokes equations to become insensible in finite time.

This route is a niche vector of attack; mathematicians agree it is not possible to arrive at by feeding the problem to an AI chatbot. This detail matters to what followed.

How did OpenAI get involved?

Buckmaster and Alpöge made a breakthrough on August 15. A week later, the duo had their proofs – heavily



While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution for the Navier-Stokes regularity problem in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed 100-page proof. GROWTIKA/UNSPLASH

generated by models like Anthropic’s Claude and OpenAI’s GPT-5.6 Sol – checked by a computer to make sure the mathematics were correct.

However, the raw output from the AI was practically unreadable. Buckmaster described one initial proof as “the most horrendous I have ever read”. So Alpöge and Buckmaster spent weeks working around the clock to translate the AI output into a readable paper.

But last week, a rumor began circulating that Anthropic had solved a major open problem in mathematics. On September 3, after hearing OpenAI was investigating the rumors, Buckmaster emailed a prominent mathematician at OpenAI. This information comes from a statement that Buckmaster published on his university webpage.

Buckmaster said he clarified that his work with Alpöge was in a personal capacity and did not represent an institutional effort by Anthropic and that the duo planned to publish its results once it had finished polishing the manuscript. The (unnamed) interlocutor at OpenAI replied expressing excitement.

But on September 4, OpenAI requested a same-day meeting with Buckmaster, which Buckmaster deferred to the following week (i.e., the current week). Two days later, OpenAI urgently requested a meeting, so Buckmaster said he joined a call with OpenAI computer scientist Sebastian Bubeck and another representative. Alpöge did not attend the call.

During this call, Buckmaster said Bubeck dropped a bombshell: an internal OpenAI model had produced a proof of finite-time blow-up for the forced Navier-Stokes equations. When Buckmaster pressed for details, the OpenAI team revealed their solution was exactly “Existence of forced blowup in R3 and T3, with the forcing function is smooth Option C and D in Fefferman” – for Buckmaster, the exact mathematical

route he and Alpöge had been pursuing.

Buckmaster also wrote that he and Alpöge had been logging their work on OpenAI Codex, a tool to translate natural language prompts into code, for months.

At this point, Buckmaster refused to cooperate with OpenAI and rushed to publish his and Alpöge’s results, plus his public statement.

OpenAI subsequently held a press briefing in which it claimed 10,000 AI agents had cracked the problem in an 88-hour marathon that had cost the company millions of dollars.

What is the data-access issue?

Buckmaster’s public statement has already triggered scrutiny of OpenAI’s corporate practices. When it claimed to have solved the same formulation of the problem Buckmaster and Alpöge had been working on, Buckmaster asked how the AI model had arrived there. On the September 6 call, Bubeck allegedly admitted an entire team had been assigned to crack the problem.

Further, Buckmaster said he had been inputting all of his and Alpöge’s drafts into Codex over a year. So when Buckmaster asked if the internal OpenAI model had been trained on or had access to his private Codex sessions, OpenAI said the model “did not look up user data”. But when Buckmaster pressed on whether his data had been used to train the model that worked on the problem, OpenAI didn’t answer.

According to Buckmaster, Bubeck also offered him two unethical proposals. In the first, Buckmaster would post his significant result and OpenAI would post their Navier-Stokes result the following day. The second was that Buckmaster would write a solo paper presenting the Navier-Stokes result and acknowledge the internal OpenAI model.

Bubeck reportedly asserted on the call that he wanted Alpöge removed from authorship because Alpöge is an

employee of Anthropic, OpenAI’s rival.

Buckmaster said he refused both offers and threatened to go public with the conversation, whereupon Bubeck allegedly responded: “Why would you ruin your career?” and “If you don’t want me to be nice, then I don’t have to be nice”.

Bubeck has since publicly called the allegations against him “false and inflammatory”.

What questions remain?

1. Did OpenAI actually solve the problem? While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed proof. Since Buckmaster described the AI-generated paper as “slop”, it is also unknown whether OpenAI’s internal model actually produced a rigorous proof or a convoluted approximation.

2. Did OpenAI breach user privacy? The silence regarding whether OpenAI trained its internal model on Buckmaster’s private Codex logs has been deafening.

3. Who deserves the credit? The AI agents? OpenAI the corporation? Buckmaster and Alpöge? Or Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zoróa? Indeed, Buckmaster wrote in his statement he believes “Luis Martínez-Zoróa deserves a Fields Medal”.

Just before the controversy broke out, Fields Medal winner Terence Tao had published a series of notes about why a ‘human mathematics’ remains relevant in the age of AI. As he wrote: “The point remains that there is a substantial opportunity cost in converting a historically productive and motivating problem ... into a mere viral social media post advertising some benchmark progress, rather than actually advancing the field and developing the next generation of both problems to ask and people to work on them.”

THE GIST

The Navier-Stokes equations describe fluid motion and form one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems, with a \$1 million prize for a valid solution

Buckmaster and Alpöge used AI models to develop a proof of finite-time blow-up involving a forcing function, then worked to turn the AI-generated output into a readable paper

OpenAI later said 10,000 AI agents had solved the problem in an 88-hour effort, while Buckmaster alleged that OpenAI made questionable proposals over publication and authorship

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Cong. alleges ₹10,000-cr. tax evasion through 'bogus' political parties, seeks JPC

Rahul's 'Goonj' impact won't extend beyond Congress workers: Nabin

In Rahul case, CJI says all parties are treated equally

Withdraw stand on Gram Sabha consent, rights group urges Ministry

The statement comes amid criticisms of the Ministry's communication to the Power Ministry, with which it is currently in discussions about how the requirement of 100% Gram Sabha consent for diversion of forest land has become a "critical bottleneck" delaying large government projects, as first reported by *The Hindu*. Congress leader Jairam Ramesh had also criticised the position of the Ministry as a "shocking stance".

BJD stages protest over Mines and Minerals Amendment Act

Dr. B. R. AMBEDKAR UNIVERSITY DELHI
(Established by the Act of Legislative Assembly of National Capital Territory of Delhi)

**RECRUITMENT NOTICE FOR TEACHING POSTS
(NOTICE REGARDING EXTENSION OF LAST DATES TO APPLY)**

No. AUD/55-1(67)/Rect./2026/929 Dated: 03.09.2026

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar University Delhi, a State University established through an Act by the Legislature of the National Capital Territory of Delhi, invited online applications from the eligible candidates for the faculty positions (Professor, Associate Professor and Assistant Professor) on regular basis vide Advertisement No. AUD/55-1(67)/Rect./2026/838 dated 31.07.2026. In continuation of the same the last date to apply online and submit application in hard copy form are being extended as follows:

- **Last date to apply online: 19.09.2026 (up to 23:59 hrs)**
- **Last date of receiving applications in hard copy form: 28.09.2026 (up to 17:30 hrs)**

For Qualifications, Eligibility Criteria, General Instructions, Online Application Form, Payment of Fee and other details, please visit University website: <https://aud.delhi.gov.in>

Lothian Road, Kashmere Gate, Delhi – 110 006, Email: careers@aud.ac.in REGISTRAR

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0205/26-27

Directorate of Higher Education, Govt. of NCT of Delhi

Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) on Wednesday launched *Sagar Manthan*, an indigenous ocean research vessel being built for the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), in a major boost to India's capabilities in deep-sea exploration and scientific research. A top government official said the ₹840-crore research vessel is expected to be ready for use by early 2028. Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh congratulated GRSE and the Ministry of Earth Sciences on the launch and naming of the vessel and conveyed his wishes on the occasion. ^{PTI}

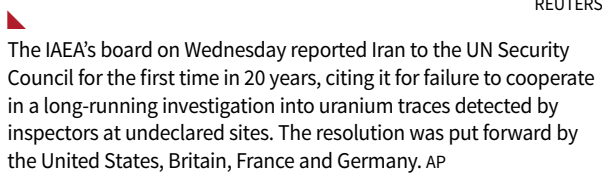
An Indian national who was killed during a deadly riot at a prison in Negombo in Sri Lanka in July was buried under special police protection, authorities said. The Criminal Investigation Department told the Negombo Magistrate's Court on Tuesday that the burial of the 73-year-old inmate on September 2 was carried out in accordance with the court's directive and at state expense. According to media reports, the victim, identified as Sarathchandran Unnithan, was from Kerala but had been living in Chennai for more than four decades. He had arrived in Sri Lanka on March 2 and was arrested on charges of possessing ganja.

Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan on Wednesday underlined Arunachal Pradesh's strategic importance to India and said the State was an integral part of the country's unity. Addressing a special session of the State's 60-member Assembly, he said the northeastern State plays a vital role in safeguarding India's borders. Mr. Radhakrishnan also highlighted the nation's diversity. The Vice-President's statement comes as New Delhi flagged "anomalies" in the United Nations' new world map depicting Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin, two integral parts of India, as separate regions positioned between the borders claimed by India and China.

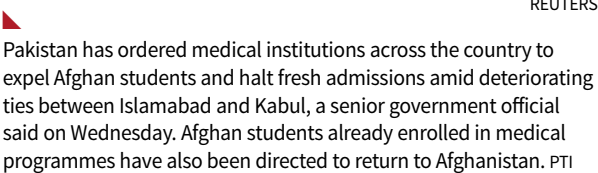
A probe into the alleged terror offences involving six Ukrainian citizens and one U.S. national, who were arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) in March on charges of training anti-India armed groups in Myanmar, continues to look into whether they were engaged in activities prejudicial to India's security, government sources said. As per the NIA, the accused persons provided training in drone assembly and operation, drone warfare and jamming technology to members of Myanmar-based ethnic armed groups, including the Chin National Front (CNF) and the Kachin Independence Army (KIA).

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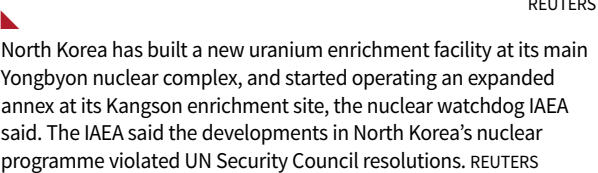
IAEA's board reports Iran to UNSC for 'failing to cooperate with probe'



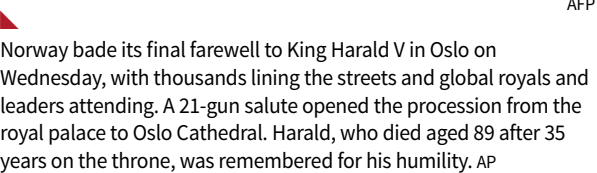
Pakistan orders medical colleges to expel students from Afghanistan



North Korea builds new Yongbyon uranium enrichment facility: IAEA



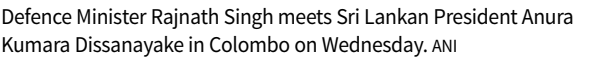
Norway bids final farewell to King Harald V at his funeral



The agreements cover upgrading L70 guns for Sri Lankan Air Force and cooperation between the two countries' National Cadet Corps, National Defence Colleges; this is the first visit by an Indian Defence Minister to Sri Lanka in nearly 40 years

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Wednesday pledged India's continued support to Sri Lanka during a meeting with Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake in Colombo, as the two countries inked three Memoranda of Understanding (MoU) on defence equipment and training.

Mr. Singh's visit, the first by an Indian Defence Minister to Sri Lanka in nearly 40 years, and the agreements come over a year after Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Sri Lanka.



ka in 2025, when seven MoUs, including an overarching defence sector agreement, were signed. The MoUs signed on Wednesday pertain to the upgradation of L70 Guns for the Sri Lankan Air Force, and cooperation between the National Cadet Corps and the National Defence Colleges of the

During President Dissanayake's meeting with Mr. Singh, the two sides held "extensive discussions on further strengthening the existing defence, economic, maritime and regional partnerships between India and Sri Lanka", the Presidential Media Unit said in a statement.

Mutual interests

Further, Mr. Dissanayake briefed Mr. Singh on Sri Lanka's recently-launched islandwide programme to combat drug trafficking.

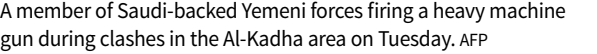
An official release from the Indian government said the President recalled his interactions with Mr.

emen's Houthi rebels reported dozens of Saudi air strikes on Wednesday as daily attacks continued in a conflict that has reignited during the West Asia war, with hundreds of people killed in fighting near the Red Sea.

More than 40 attacks targeted several regions including the flashpoint areas of Taiz and Hodeida, the scene of fierce clashes between the Houthis and Saudi-backed government, the rebels said.

"It's a catastrophe, and the attacks are ongoing," said Mohammed Khudairi, one of nearly 20,000 who fled the fighting, according to the International Organization for Migration.

The latest salvos in Ye-



men's previously dormant conflict come a day after the Houthis set oil sites ablaze and wounded 73 in their heaviest missile and drone attacks against Saudi Arabia in years.

Saudi air strikes targeted "various areas across the governorates of Marib, Al-Jawf, Taiz and Hodeida", the rebels' *Almasirah*

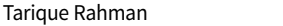
U.K. Prime Minister Andy Burnham defended on Wednesday his government's ban on trade with illegal Israeli settlements in the West Bank after Israel retaliated against London-led Western sanctions over settler violence.

Israel ordered the closure of Britain's consulate in Jerusalem among other measures in response to the sanctions move on Tuesday by 12 countries, which condemned violence against Palestinians in the territory.

"Where people are being bullied out of their homes, intimidated, we will always stand with the underdog and take what action we can to support them," Mr. Burnham said.

Bangladesh Prime Minister Tareque Rahman is keen to visit India at the earliest but is concerned about take-away points and achievements that he will have to produce before his audience back home after a visit of this nature, said a diplomatic source of Bangladesh to *The Hindu* on Wednesday.

The official said Mr. Rahman might have skipped the multilateral BRICS summit for which he was invited by India, but that does not mean that he is trying to avoid an immediate and important neighbour like India, which has contributed and sacrificed immensely during Bangladesh's Liberation War of 1971. Mr. Rahman is aware that he may have to visit Delhi in a bilateral frame-



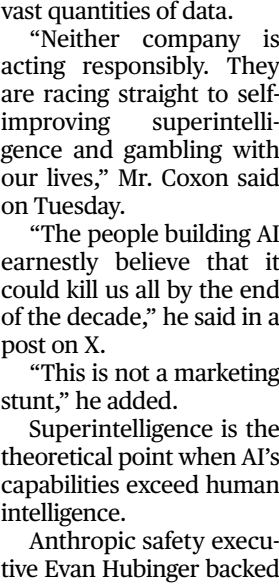
work by November or early December, as the Ganga Water Treaty needs to be renewed at the earliest as it will otherwise lapse by the end of December, 2026, said the official.

The official said Mr. Rahman's visit requires setting of the agenda through intensive meetings between the officials of the two sides that are yet to begin. But Dhaka believes that apart from the Ganga Wa-

An artificial intelligence researcher who left OpenAI to join Anthropic has decided to leave the industry, accusing both U.S. companies of “playing with our lives” in the race to develop AI models capable of self-improvement.

Jacob Coxon, 27, spent the past three years pretraining AI models, first at OpenAI and then, this year, at its rival Anthropic, which he considered more cautious in its approach.

Pretraining is the stage where AI models absorb



“We really do earnestly believe AI could kill all humans!” he said, adding that he estimated that risk at more than 10% over the next decade.

Mr. Coxon's resignation comes as Anthropic prepares for its market debut, following a summer marked by unauthorised hacks carried out by AI tools during testing. "At Anthropic, the stakes are well-understood, but they are locked in a race to get there first, despite the risk," he said.

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Form doesn't really matter when it comes to the World championship battle

The French GM says that the upcoming Olympiad at Samarkand would be an ideal indicator of Gukesh and Sindarov's mindset; feels that the game needs to find a format which is spectator-friendly



INTERVIEW

Maxime Vachier-Lagrave

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Only 15 chess players have touched 2800 Elo points on the FIDE rating list. Arjun Erigaisi was the last to reach there, and it has been two years since. Maxime Vachier-Lagrave crossed the mark in 2016. With a peak rating of 2819, the French Grandmaster is the seventh strongest player in chess history. He is a former World No. 2, and won the World Blitz championship in 2021. MVL, as he is often called, has been playing regularly in India and is now in Bengaluru for the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League. He has played in every single edition of the league. Excerpts from an interview Vachier-Lagrave gave *The Hindu*:

You have played in every season of the Global Chess League.

I think it is really fun. The idea of having people can cheer on at the venue is nice, and you have all the best players in the world. It is also interesting to see the prodigies in the teams and how they go on to make it big later.

You had Javokhir Sindarov as a prodigy, and now he is a challenger for the World Championship match. And we had D. Gukesh (who will play Sindarov in that match) for the first three seasons as well.

It is also a lot of fun to watch these innovations, such as the time control with no increment. And everyone in the team having the same colour for a match is really a nice experience.

Do you like the system of getting more points with black pieces than white?

That is enjoyable. And it is good to



have games that don't last too long and are easy to watch.

And it is better for the television audience, too.

Yeah, that you don't want to be glued for four hours, and sometimes nothing happens for 30 minutes.

How do you find the idea of playing with no increment for the first 40 moves?

When I was a kid, we barely had digital clocks, so it is alright. I still prefer the digital clocks, but we have increment after the 40th move, so it is not as ruthless.

What are your thoughts on the upcoming World championship match between Gukesh and Sindarov?

You never know with matches, how it turns out. At the last World championship, Gukesh was coming in really strong, while Ding Liren looked like he couldn't play chess. Suddenly, you know, Gukesh was under pressure.

It was the same with the previous match, when Ding played against Ian Nepomniachtchi. It looked as if Nepo was winning it. So the form doesn't really matter when it comes to the

World championship match. Yes, Gukesh has been struggling a little bit with his results, but I think he has also been experimenting and, you know, got maybe too much out of his comfort zone.

But in general, when he is playing really well, he is a formidable opponent. I remember having some really good clashes with him. And he had some exceptional performances at the Olympiads.

One thing that I noticed about Gukesh is that, especially ever since he became World champion, it seems like he has to prove a point with every game he plays.

And sometimes that, you know, you cannot have as much energy as that to be there for every game, fighting it out. And, you know, he always takes a lot of risks. And when he is in very good shape, he has a lot of energy, it works out well for him, I think.

But if you get even a slight drop in energy, the consequences can be brutal because his chess requires so much energy and so much confidence as well.

From my point of view, a defining turning point could be the next Olympiad. If Gukesh capitalises on the confidence gained from his performances in his previous two Olympiads, and does a great performance again in this Olympiad

(starting next week at Samarkand), he can go into the World championship in a much better mood.

I think it would be very helpful for him if he gets a little bit of confidence back. He needs some sort of break to be certain that he can play his best chess again.

If he plays like he can, there is simply no favourite in my mind. You have two very strong young players who will be fighting it out.

What makes Sindarov different? He has been brilliant for the last year or so, having won the World Cup and then that absolutely dominant performance to win the Candidates...

He seems to be handling his nerves very well. And of course, his calculation is very good. But like at some point, you know, the difference is some little make or break.

The margins are very narrow, of course, in top level chess. So, it could also be like a very good break.

We will see what happens in the World championship match and before that at the Olympiad as well.

He is an extremely strong player and he is having a very good year. But there are so many good players around.

The Olympiad is coming up right after the Global Chess League and India is the defending champion.

The Indian team is so strong. And we don't know who will be playing on the top board. If France gets to play against them, I will probably be more interested in finding out who is on board one, so that I could prepare.

You will be playing at the pilot event of the newly launched Total World Chess Championship tour.

That is a very exciting event. I am glad that I have managed to qualify, and I hope to make it to the main cycle.

On that tour, the classical bit is

going to be of a duration of 45 minutes and they are calling it fast classical.

I am okay with that. Of course, it matters how I perform individually. But I also care about how chess will evolve as a game and as a spectator sport.

And there is now more money in chess too, especially when you compare with the time you started out.

Yes, chess is on the rise. And I think it is a good opportunity for the game. You have many more players coming into the game. You have many more investors coming too, and trying to get a cut of the action. And I think that is really nice. And we get to experiment a bit.

This is all good for the game. And we need to find out what will be the ideal format for spectators to watch. We also need sometimes the players to evolve a bit and to be ready to give them some of their energy, not only towards the preparation.

As a player, I know preparing for your game is important, but you should also be able to give something back to the game.

R. Praggnanandhaa has been having a great time of late.

I think early last year, he also had some great six, eight months, but then there was a toll of playing so much.

And he had a disappointing Candidates.

But I think he has been working on his stamina and is also able to fight it out always. But we always knew that Pragg was also an exceptionally strong player.

What is next for you after the GCL and the Olympiad?

There is the Total Chess World Championship in Budapest, and then the World rapid and blitz.

How scientists are using menstrual blood in osteoarthritis treatment

Much like saliva or blood plasma, menstrual fluid is rich with biological information; it is packed with immune cells, endometrial tissue, proteins, and genetic fragments; scientists are digging into these biomarkers to find ways to detect diseases early, and drop the use of invasive clinical procedures

Manjeera Gowravaram

For most of history, menstrual blood has been dismissed as biological waste. But emerging research is now recasting this material as a goldmine for non-invasive diagnostics and regenerative medicine. Its potential applications are surprisingly broad, ranging from innovative cervical cancer screenings to advanced cartilage repair.

Much like saliva or blood plasma, menstrual fluid is rich with biological information. It is packed with immune cells, endometrial tissue, proteins, and genetic fragments.

Scientists are now digging into these biomarkers hoping to find ways to detect diseases early, and thus drop the use of invasive clinical procedures.

Stem cells

Researchers have recently reported that they had used menstrual blood to spot cancer early. Normally, medical workers have screened for cervical cancer using clinical check-ups that many people skip due to discomfort, cost, limited access to healthcare, and in fact plain embarrassment. As a result, screening rates remain low even in economically developed regions.

In 2025, a large population-based study in *The BMJ* by researchers from China offered a workaround. The team found that menstrual blood collected directly from sanitary pads could be tested for human papillomavirus DNA and precancerous lesions just as accurately as cervical swab samples collected by a clinician. Of course, the method excludes those who do not menstruate, but the fact that it offered a non-invasive, inexpensive, and suitable test that could begin from home is notable.

Menstrual blood is also gaining research focus thanks to stem cells derived from it. The groundwork for this was laid back in 2007 when a team from the U.S. and Canada successfully isolated menstrual stem cells from menstrual blood. These cells came from the endometrium, the uterine lining that breaks down and rebuilds itself on a monthly cycle without scarring – something other human tissue cannot do. The researchers believed the stem cells had something to do with that ability. In the lab, the menstrual-blood-derived stem cells readily divided and proved to be tough and versatile.

Researchers are already using them to grow uterine organoids – small functional models of the uterus located outside the body and used to study conditions like endometriosis. The stem cells could reveal traces of exposure to chemical compounds like phthalates and parabens, which was previously not possible to discern without an invasive examination.

Indeed, while bone marrow stem cells are still the gold standard for many therapies, extracting them is a gruelling process. It is painful, requires anaesthesia, and bears significant surgical risks. Menstrual-blood-derived stem cells however can be collected non-invasively, and sans the ethical baggage that often complicates stem-cell sourcing.

As the science of these cells has matured, so have their applications. For instance, in 2025, a team in China studied



While most current treatments for osteoarthritis mask the pain, new findings suggest a way to actually slow or reverse the damage. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

the role they could play on Niemann-Pick disease type CI. This is a rare and devastating inherited condition that is caused by cholesterol and lipids build-up inside cells, leading to rapid neurological decline, loss of motor function, and dementia. The study found that menstrual-blood-derived stem cells could significantly lower neuroinflammation and cell death in experimental models of the disease. The work is still in its early stages, but for a condition whose therapeutic options are currently limited to drugs easing the clinical symptoms, a potential new advance is welcome.

A 2023 study by Iranian researchers showed that when these cells were delivered alongside their conditioned medium – the nutrient-rich fluid they had been cultured with – they helped accelerate heart recovery in rat models after a heart attack.

In hepatology, menstrual-blood-derived stem cells have been found to suppress the specific liver cells responsible for scarring and fibrosis. Because they naturally migrate towards areas of inflammation and cancer, researchers are also exploring engineering these cells to deliver therapeutic genes directly to a tumour site, sparing the rest of the body from the toxic side effects of chemotherapy.

Many experts increasingly believe extracellular vesicles (EVs) are the future of regenerative medicine. They are easier to standardise than whole stem cells – which are complete, living biological units that can divide and adapt within the body,

but vary significantly from one batch to another. They also carry risks of becoming unintended tissue types. Because EVs are not whole cells, but rather clumps of proteins, lipids, RNA, and signalling molecules enclosed by membranes secreted from the parent cell, they can't divide or differentiate into other tissues. This makes them safer, more stable alternatives and less likely to trigger immune rejection, can be engineered to evade immune detection, and can be frozen and stored just like conventional biological drugs.

Menstrual-blood-derived stem cells can be made to release these EVs when cultured in specific conditions in the lab, such as hypoxia (low oxygen) or by adding inflammatory cytokines.

Ordinary challenges

In a notable study published in *Scientific Reports* in February, a team from Lithuania isolated EVs from healthy donors and introduced them to human cartilage cells taken from patients who had undergone joint surgery. Within hours, the cartilage cells had absorbed the EVs and produced a new extracellular matrix, the scaffolding of healthy joints. When the team simulated joint inflammation, the vesicles reduced the release of markers associated with cartilage degradation.

Since osteoarthritis disproportionately affects women, the researchers also tracked hormone receptors. Specifically, when they examined how EVs affected receptors in the joint tissue, they found

that the EVs had increased the expression of the progesterone receptor in cartilage cells, potentially restoring a hormonal signalling pathway that tends to deteriorate in women following menopause.

While most current treatments for osteoarthritis mask the pain, these findings suggest a way to actually slow or reverse the damage. Even though the research is nascent, if the findings hold up in future trials, any benefits will matter considering the number of people living with this condition, estimated to be 595 million worldwide in 2020.

Some significant hurdles remain as well. Scientists do not yet know how long these cells will survive once they are introduced into the body. There is no long-term human safety data – partly because there are no reliable markers to track the cells once they are inside a patient. Producing consistent, high-quality batches also remains a challenge, since no standardised benchmarks exist to verify the cells before use. The cells must themselves behave differently depending on the donor, varying with age, hormonal status, contraceptive history, and the conditions in which the cells were grown in the lab.

Then again, these are ordinary challenges of early-stage biomedical research rather than reasons to dismiss what has already been found.

(Manjeera Gowravaram has a PhD in RNA biochemistry and works as a freelance science writer: gmanjeera@gmail.com)



A view of a planetary nebula. The study focused on two extremely dense types of stellar objects – millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs. NASA

Dark matter could form tiny black holes inside stars: study

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Dark matter, the unseen substance that makes up most of the universe's matter, could play a more dramatic role than previously thought.

A new study suggests that heavy dark matter particles trapped inside a dense star could accumulate at its core, collapse into a tiny black hole roughly the mass of a loaded semi-truck, and gradually transform the entire star into a black hole.

The authors of the study, published in the latest issue of the *Physical Review D*, are H.A. Adarsha and Chandrachur Chakraborty of the Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences at Manipal Academy of Higher Education, and Sudip Bhattacharyya of Mumbai's Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR).

Two stellar objects

Their study focuses on two extremely dense types of stellar objects – millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs.

An extremely dense star is essentially a dead star that has run out of nuclear fuel. A millisecond pulsar is a rapidly rotating neutron star that emits regular beams of electromagnetic radiation at intervals of less than 10 milliseconds, while a white

A new study suggests that heavy dark matter particles trapped inside a dense star could accumulate at its core, collapse into a tiny black hole roughly the mass of a loaded semi-truck, and gradually transform the entire star into a black hole

dwarf is a hot, dense stellar remnant.

A black hole would evaporate rapidly if left on its own, but the researchers' calculations through a new mathematical framework showed that a continuous supply of dark matter could keep such tiny black holes growing inside dense stars.

The researchers used a conservative age of about 1 billion years for millisecond pulsars and about 10 billion years for white dwarfs to place limits on the possible properties of ultra-heavy dark matter.

“Hawking radiation causes black holes to lose mass, with smaller black holes evaporating faster. However, some hypothetical ultra-heavy dark matter particles could be captured by dense stellar remnants such as millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs, collect at their centres, and eventually collapse into a tiny black hole,” the researchers said.

Consumption of dark matter

They calculated what would happen next by considering a black hole's consumption of stellar material, continued feeding by dark matter, Hawking evaporation, and quantum effects important at extremely small scales.

“We find that continued dark matter feeding can allow black holes born with masses as low as about 40 tonnes to overcome evaporation and eventually consume their host stars. Because many millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs have survived for billions of years, dark matter capable of destroying them sooner can be ruled out,” the study said.

“These ancient stars, therefore, provide natural laboratories for probing forms of ultra-heavy dark matter that are difficult to test on earth,” they found.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Following the deadly glacial collapse in Nepal, a quiz on glaciers

Radhika Santhanam

QUESTION 1

During the Pleistocene Ice Age, the geological time period that includes the last ice age, glaciers covered almost one-third of all the land. Today, in which continent is the vast majority of the world's glacial ice found?

QUESTION 2

During the Last Glacial Maximum, roughly 29,000 to 19,000 years ago, when temperatures were extremely low and woolly mammoths and saber-toothed cats roamed the earth, this continent had some glaciers. Today, however, given its low mountains and warm, dry climate, it has none. Name this continent, the only one in the world without glaciers.

QUESTION 3

Located in the Karakoram range,

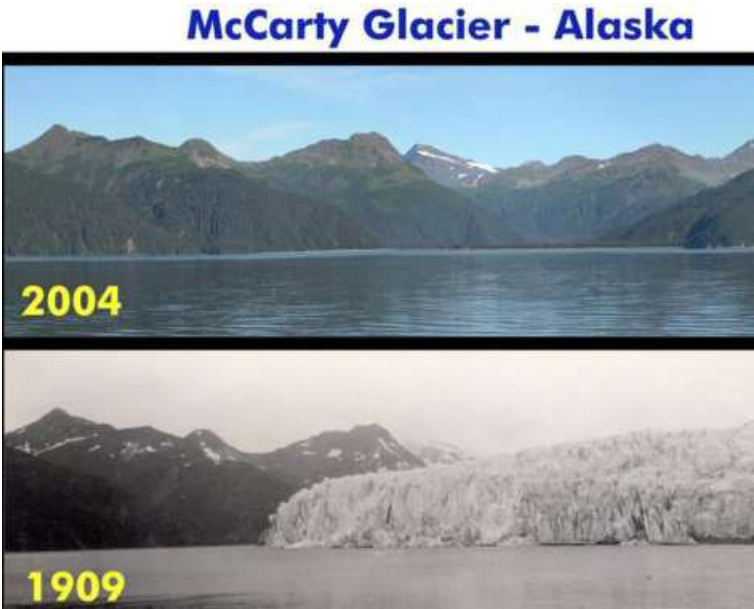
the second-highest mountain range on the earth, this glacier is one of the longest and highest outside the polar regions. It is also known as the site of the highest-altitude battlefield in the world and has a large and permanent military presence on or near it. Its name means 'place of roses'. Name it.

QUESTION 4

Nearly 70% of the world's X is locked away in glaciers and ice sheets. What is X, essential for agriculture, industry, and domestic needs? Be specific.

QUESTION 5

Outside the polar regions, this country has the most glaciers: over 7,000. It is also the world's largest importer of tea, contains the world's highest polo ground, and has one of the highest shares of mountain terrain in South Asia. Name the country.



Visual: The image shows Alaska's McCartney Glacier in Kenai Fjords National Park. In under a century, the glacier receded by about 15 km. There is dense vegetation on the slopes, once covered by ice. What is the phenomenon illustrated in this image called? PUBLIC DOMAIN

Answers to September 3 quiz:

- Effective mood stabiliser whose mechanism of action is unclear – **Ans: Lithium**
- Immobility-inducing substance whose molecular effects are unclear – **Ans: Anaesthesia**
- Compounds, some of which exhibit a mystery form of superconductivity – **Ans: Cuprates**
- First-line drug used to treat type-II diabetes – **Ans: Metformin**
- Drug from phencyclidine that can lift depression in hours – **Ans: Ketamine**

Visual: **Turbulence**

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